

THE ALCHEMIST

Ben Jonson



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BEN JONSON

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DRAMATIS PERSONAE

- Subtle, the Alchemist
- Face, the Housekeeper
- Dol Common, their Colleague
- Dapper, a Lawyer's Clerk
- Drugger, a Tobacco Man
- Lovewit, Master of the House
- Sir Epicure Mammon, a Knight
- Pertinax Surly, a Gamester
- Tribulation Wholesome, a Pastor of Amsterdam
- Ananias, a Deacon there
- Kastril, the angry Boy
- Dame Pliant, his Sister, a Widow
- Neighbours
- Officers, Attendants, etc.

Scene: London.

The Alchemist to the lady most deserving her name and blood: Lady Mary Wroth.

Madam,

In the age of sacrifices, the truth of religion was not in the greatness and fat of the offerings, but in the devotion and zeal of the sacrificers: else what could a handle of gums have done in the sight of a hecatomb? or how might I appear at this altar, except with those affections that no less love the light and witness, than they have the conscience of your virtue? If what I offer bear an acceptable odour, and hold the first strength, it is your value of it, which remembers where, when, and to whom it was kindled. Otherwise, as the times are, there comes rarely forth that thing so full of authority or example, but by assiduity and custom grows less, and loses. This, yet, safe in your judgment (which is a Sidney's) is forbidden to speak more, lest it talk or look like one of the ambitious faces of the time, who, the more they paint, are the less themselves.

Your ladyship's true honourer,

Ben Jonson

TO THE READER

If thou beest more, thou art an understander, and then I trust thee. If thou art one that takest up, and but a pretender, beware of what hands thou receivest thy commodity; for thou wert never more fair in the way to be cozened, than in this age, in poetry, especially in plays: wherein, now the concupiscence of dances and of antics so reigneth, as to run away from nature, and be afraid of her, is the only point of art that tickles the spectators. But how out of purpose, and place, do I name art? When the professors are grown so obstinate contemners of it, and presumers on their own naturals, as they are deriders of all diligence that way, and, by simple mocking at the terms, when they understand not the things, think to get off wittily with their ignorance. Nay, they are esteemed the more learned, and sufficient for this, by the many, through their excellent vice of judgment. For they commend writers, as they do fencers or wrestlers; who if they come in robustuously, and put for it with a great deal of violence, are received for the braver fellows: when many times their own rudeness is the cause of their disgrace, and a little touch of their adversary gives all that boisterous force the foil. I deny not, but that these men, who always seek to do more than enough, may some time happen on some thing that is good, and great; but very seldom; and when it comes it doth not recompense the rest of their ill. It sticks out, perhaps, and is more eminent, because all is sordid and vile about it: as lights are more discerned in a thick darkness, than a faint shadow. I speak not this, out of a hope to do good to any man against his will; for I know, if it were put to the question of theirs and mine, the worse would find more suffrages: because the most favour common errors. But I give thee this warning, that there is a great difference between those, that, to gain the opinion of copy, utter all they can, however unfitly; and those that use elec-

tion and a mean. For it is only the disease of the unskilful, to think rude things greater than polished; or scattered more numerous than composed.

THE ALCHEMIST

ARGUMENT

The sickness hot, a master quit, for fear,
His house in town, and left one servant there;
Ease him corrupted, and gave means to know
A Cheater, and his punk; who now brought low,
Leaving their narrow practice, were become
Cozeners at large; and only wanting some
House to set up, with him they here contract,
Each for a share, and all begin to act.
Much company they draw, and much abuse,
In casting figures, telling fortunes, news,
Selling of flies, flat bawdry with the stone,
Till it, and they, and all in fume are gone.

PROLOGUE

Fortune, that favours fools, these two short hours,
We wish away, both for your sakes and ours,
Judging spectators; and desire, in place,
To the author justice, to ourselves but grace.
Our scene is London, 'cause we would make known,
No country's mirth is better than our own:
No clime breeds better matter for your whore,
Bawd, squire, impostor, many persons more,
Whose manners, now called humours, feed the stage;
And which have still been subject for the rage
Or spleen of comic writers. Though this pen
Did never aim to grieve, but better men;
Howe'er the age he lives in doth endure
The vices that she breeds, above their cure.
But when the wholesome remedies are sweet,
And in their working gain and profit meet,
He hopes to find no spirit so much diseased,
But will with such fair correctives be pleased:
For here he doth not fear who can apply.
If there be any that will sit so nigh
Unto the stream, to look what it doth run,
They shall find things, they'd think or wish were done;
They are so natural follies, but so shown,
As even the doers may see, and yet not own.

ACT I

SCENE I

A room in LOVEWIT'S house.

Face Believ't, I will.

Subtle Thy worst. I fart at thee.

Dol Common Have you your wits? Why, gentlemen! For love—

Face Sirrah, I'll strip you—

Subtle What to do? Lick figs
 Out at my—

Face Rogue, rogue!—out of all your sleights.

Dol Common Nay, look ye, sovereign, general, are you madmen?

Subtle O, let the wild sheep loose. I'll gum your silks
 With good strong water, an you come.

 Will you have

Dol Common The neighbours hear you? Will you betray all?
 Hark! I hear somebody.

Face Sirrah—

Subtle I shall mar
 All that the tailor has made, if you approach.

Face You most notorious whelp, you insolent slave,
 Dare you do this?

Subtle Yes, faith; yes, faith.

Face	Why, who Am I, my mongrel? Who am I?
Subtle	I'll tell you, Since you know not yourself.
Face	Speak lower, rogue.
Subtle	Yes, you were once (time's not long past) the good, Honest, plain, livery-three-pound-thrum, that kept Your master's worship's house here in the Friars, For the vacations —
Face	Will you be so loud?
Subtle	Since, by my means, translated Suburb-Captain.
Face	By your means, Doctor Dog!
Subtle	Within man's memory, All this I speak of.
Face	Why, I pray you, have I Been countenanced by you, or you by me? Do but collect, sir, where I met you first.
Subtle	I do not hear well. Not of this, I think it. But I shall put you in mind, sir; — at Pie-corner, Taking your meal of steam in, from cooks' stalls, Where, like the father of hunger, you did walk Piteously costive, with your pinched-horn-nose, And your complexion of the Roman wash, Stuck full of black and melancholic worms, Like powder corns shot at the artillery-yard.
Subtle	I wish you could advance your voice a little. When you went pinned up in the several rags You had raked and picked from dunghills, before day;
Face	Your feet in mouldy slippers, for your kibes; A felt of rug, and a thin threaden cloak, That scarce would cover your no buttocks —
Subtle	So, sir!
Face	When all your alchemy, and your algebra, Your minerals, vegetals, and animals,

Your conjuring, cozening, and your dozen of trades,
Could not relieve your corps with so much linen
Would make you tinder, but to see a fire;
I gave you countenance, credit for your coals,
Your stills, your glasses, your materials;
Built you a furnace, drew you customers,
Advanced all your black arts; lent you, beside,
A house to practise in—

Subtle Your master's house!

Face Where you have studied the more thriving skill
Of bawdry since.

Yes, in your master's house.

You and the rats here kept possession.

Subtle Make it not strange. I know you were one could keep
The buttery-hatch still locked, and save the chippings,
Sell the dole beer to aqua-vitae men,
The which, together with your Christmas vails
At post-and-pair, your letting out of counters,
Made you a pretty stock, some twenty marks,
And gave you credit to converse with cobwebs,
Here, since your mistress' death hath broke up house.

Face You might talk softlier, rascal.

No, you scarab,

Subtle I'll thunder you in pieces: I will teach you
How to beware to tempt a Fury again,
That carries tempest in his hand and voice.

Face The place has made you valiant.

Subtle No, your clothes.—

Thou vermin, have I ta'en thee out of dung,
So poor, so wretched, when no living thing
Would keep thee company, but a spider, or worse?
Raised thee from brooms, and dust, and watering-pots,
Sublimed thee, and exalted thee, and fixed thee
In the third region, called our state of grace?
Wrought thee to spirit, to quintessence, with pains
Would twice have won me the philosopher's work?

Put thee in words and fashion, made thee fit
For more than ordinary fellowships?
Given thee thy oaths, thy quarrelling dimensions,
Thy rules to cheat at horse-race, cock-pit, cards,
Dice, or whatever gallant tincture else?
Made thee a second in mine own great art?
And have I this for thanks! Do you rebel,
Do you fly out in the projection?
Would you be gone now?

Dol Common Gentlemen, what mean you?
Will you mar all?

Subtle Slave, thou hadst had no name —

Dol Common Will you undo yourselves with civil war?

Never been known, past *equi clibanum*,
The heat of horse-dung, under ground, in cellars,
Subtle Or an alehouse darker than deaf John's; been lost
To all mankind, but laundresses and tapsters,
Had not I been.

Dol Common Do you know who hears you, Sovereign?

Face Sirrah —

Dol Common Nay, General, I thought you were civil.

Face I shall turn desperate, if you grow thus loud.

Subtle And hang thyself, I care not.

Hang thee, collier,
Face And all thy pots, and pans, in picture, I will,
Since thou hast moved me —

Dol Common O, this will o'erthrow all.

Write thee up bawd in Paul's, have all thy tricks
Of cozening with a hollow coal, dust, scrapings,
Searching for things lost, with a sieve and sheers,
Face Erecting figures in your rows of houses,
And taking in of shadows with a glass,
Told in red letters; and a face cut for thee,
Worse than Gamaliel Ratsey's.

Dol Common Are you sound?

Have you your senses, masters?
I will have
Face A book, but barely reckoning thy impostures,
Shall prove a true philosopher's stone to printers.
Subtle Away, you trencher-rascal!
Face Out, you dog-leech!
The vomit of all prisons —
Dol Common Will you be
Your own destructions, gentlemen?
Face Still spewed out
For lying too heavy on the basket.
Subtle Cheater!
Face Bawd!
Subtle Cowherd!
Face Conjuror!
Subtle Cutpurse!
Face Witch!
O me!
Dol Common We are ruined, lost! Have you no more regard
To your reputations? Where's your judgment? 'Slight,
Have yet some care of me, of your republic —
Away, this brach! I'll bring thee, rogue, within
Face The statute of sorcery, *tricesimo tertio*
Of Harry the Eighth: ay, and perhaps thy neck
Within a noose, for laundering gold and barbing it.
Dol Common *Snatches FACE's sword.*
You'll bring your head within a cockscomb, will you?
And you, sir, with your menstrue —
Dashes SUBTLE's vial out of his hand.
Gather it up. —
'Sdeath, you abominable pair of stinkards,
Leave off your barking, and grow one again,
Or, by the light that shines, I'll cut your throats.
I'll not be made a prey unto the marshal,
For ne'er a snarling dog-bolt of you both.

Have you together cozened all this while,
And all the world, and shall it now be said,
You've made most courteous shift to cozen yourselves?

To FACE.

You will accuse him! You will "bring him in
Within the statute!" Who shall take your word?
A whoreson, upstart, apocryphal Captain,
Whom not a Puritan in Blackfriars will trust
So much as for a feather:

To SUBTLE.

and you, too,
Will give the cause, forsooth! You will insult,
And claim a primacy in the divisions!
You must be chief! As if you only had
The powder to project with, and the work
Were not begun out of equality?
The venture tripartite? All things in common?
Without priority? 'Sdeath! You perpetual curs,
Fall to your couples again, and cozen kindly,
And heartily, and lovingly, as you should,
And lose not the beginning of a term,
Or, by this hand, I shall grow factious too,
And take my part, and quit you.

'Tis his fault;

Face He ever murmurs, and objects his pains,
And says, the weight of all lies upon him.

Subtle Why, so it does.

Dol Common How does it? Do not we
Sustain our parts?

Subtle Yes, but they are not equal.

Dol Common Why, if your part exceed today, I hope
Ours may, tomorrow match it.

Subtle Ay, they *may*.

Dol Common May, murmuring mastiff! Ay, and do. Death on me!
Help me to throttle him.

Seizes SUBTLE by the throat.

Subtle Dorothy! Mistress Dorothy!
'Ods precious, I'll do anything. What do you mean?

Dol Common Because o' your fermentation and cibation?

Subtle Not I, by heaven—
Your Sol and Luna

Dol Common *To FACE.*
—help me.

Subtle Would I were hanged then? I'll conform myself.

Dol Common Will you, sir? Do so then, and quickly: swear.

Subtle What should I swear?

Dol Common To leave your faction, sir,
And labour kindly in the common work.
Let me not breathe if I meant aught beside.

Subtle I only used those speeches as a spur
To him.

Dol Common I hope we need no spurs, sir. Do we?

Face 'Slid, prove today, who shall shark best.

Subtle Agreed.

Dol Common Yes, and work close and friendly.

Subtle 'Slight, the knot
Shall grow the stronger for this breach, with me.
They shake hands.
Why, so, my good baboons! Shall we go make
A sort of sober, scurvy, precise neighbours,
That scarce have smiled twice since the king came in,
A feast of laughter at our follies? Rascals,
Would run themselves from breath, to see me ride,
Or you t' have but a hole to thrust your heads in,

Dol Common For which you should pay ear-rent? No, agree.
And may Don Provost ride a feasting long,
In his old velvet jerkin and stained scarfs,
My noble Sovereign, and worthy General,
Ere we contribute a new crewel garter
To his most worsted worship.

Subtle Royal Dol!
 Spoken like Claridiana, and thyself.
 For which at supper, thou shalt sit in triumph,
 Face And not be styled Dol Common, but Dol Proper,
 Dol Singular: the longest cut at night,
 Shall draw thee for his Dol Particular.
 Bell rings without.

Subtle Who's that? One rings. To the window, Dol:
 Exit DOL.
 —pray heaven,
 The master do not trouble us this quarter.
 O, fear not him. While there dies one a week
 O' the plague, he's safe, from thinking toward London.
 Beside, he's busy at his hop-yards now;
 Face I had a letter from him. If he do,
 He'll send such word, for airing of the house,
 As you shall have sufficient time to quit it:
 Though we break up a fortnight, 'tis no matter.
 Re-enter DOL.

Subtle Who is it, Dol?
 Dol Common A fine young quodling.
 O,
 My lawyer's clerk, I lighted on last night,
 Face In Holborn, at the Dagger. He would have
 (I told you of him) a familiar,
 To rifle with at horses, and win cups.

Dol Common O, let him in.

Subtle Stay. Who shall do't?

Face Get you
 Your robes on: I will meet him as going out.

Dol Common And what shall I do?

Face Not be seen; away!
 Exit DOL.
 Seem you very reserved.

Subtle Enough.
 Exit.
 Aloud and retiring.

Face God be wi' you, sir,
 I pray you let him know that I was here:
 His name is Dapper. I would gladly have stayed, but —

Dapper *Within.* Captain, I am here.

Face Who's that? — He's come, I think, Doctor.
 Enter DAPPER.
 Good faith, sir, I was going away.

Dapper In truth
 I am very sorry, Captain.

Face But I thought
 Sure I should meet you.
 Ay, I am very glad.
 I had a scurvy writ or two to make,

Dapper And I had lent my watch last night to one
 That dines today at the sheriff's, and so was robbed
 Of my past-time.
 Re-enter SUBTLE in his velvet cap and gown.
 Is this the cunning-man?

Face This is his worship.

Dapper Is he a Doctor?

Face Yes.

Dapper And have you broke with him, Captain?

Face Ay.

Dapper And how?

Face Faith, he does make the matter, sir, so dainty
 I know not what to say.

Dapper Not so, good Captain.

Face Would I were fairly rid of it, believe me.

Dapper Nay, now you grieve me, sir. Why should you wish so?
 I dare assure you, I'll not be ungrateful.

Face	I cannot think you will, sir. But the law Is such a thing—and then he says, Read's matter Falling so lately.
Dapper	Read! He was an ass, And dealt, sir, with a fool.
Face	It was a clerk, sir.
Dapper	A clerk!
Face	Nay, hear me, sir. You know the law Better, I think—
Dapper	I should, sir, and the danger: You know, I showed the statute to you.
Face	You did so.
Dapper	And will I tell then! By this hand of flesh, Would it might never write good court-hand more, If I discover. What do you think of me, That I am a chiaus?
Face	What's that?
Dapper	The Turk was here. As one would say, do you think I am a Turk?
Face	I'll tell the Doctor so.
Dapper	Do, good sweet Captain.
Face	Come, noble Doctor, pray thee let's prevail; This is the gentleman, and he is no chiaus.
Subtle	Captain, I have returned you all my answer. I would do much, sir, for your love—But this I neither may, nor can. Tut, do not say so.
Face	You deal now with a noble fellow, Doctor, One that will thank you richly; and he is no chiaus: Let that, sir, move you.
Subtle	Pray you, forbear—
Face	He has Four angels here.
Subtle	You do me wrong, good sir.

Face	Doctor, wherein? To tempt you with these spirits? To tempt my art and love, sir, to my peril.
Subtle	Fore heaven, I scarce can think you are my friend, That so would draw me to apparent danger.
Face	I draw you! A horse draw you, and a halter, You, and your flies together—
Dapper	Nay, good Captain.
Face	That know no difference of men.
Subtle	Good words, sir. Good deeds, sir, Doctor Dogs-meat. 'Slight, I bring you No cheating Clim o' the Cloughs or Claribels, That look as big as five-and-fifty, and flush; And spit out secrets like hot custard—
Dapper	Captain! Nor any melancholic under-scribe, Shall tell the vicar; but a special gentle, That is the heir to forty marks a year, Consorts with the small poets of the time, Is the sole hope of his old grandmother; That knows the law, and writes you six fair hands, Is a fine clerk, and has his cyphering perfect. Will take his oath o' the Greek Testament, If need be, in his pocket; and can court His mistress out of Ovid.
Face	
Dapper	Nay, dear Captain—
Face	Did you not tell me so?
Dapper	Yes; but I'd have you Use master Doctor with some more respect. Hang him, proud stag, with his broad velvet head! — But for your sake, I'd choke, ere I would change An article of breath with such a puckfist: Come, let's be gone. <i>Going.</i>
Face	
Subtle	Pray you let me speak with you.

Dapper	His worship calls you, Captain.
Face	I am sorry I e'er embarked myself in such a business.
Dapper	Nay, good sir; he did call you.
Face	Will he take then?
Subtle	First, hear me—
Face	Not a syllable, 'less you take.
Subtle	Pray you, sir—
Face	Upon no terms but an <i>assumpsit</i> .
Subtle	Your humour must be law. <i>He takes the four angels.</i>
	Why now, sir, talk.
Face	Now I dare hear you with mine honour. Speak. So may this gentleman too.
Subtle	Why, sir— <i>Offering to whisper FACE.</i>
Face	No whispering.
Subtle	Fore heaven, you do not apprehend the loss You do yourself in this.
Face	Wherein? For what?
Subtle	Marry, to be so importunate for one, That, when he has it, will undo you all: He'll win up all the money in the town.
Face	How!
	Yes, and blow up gamester after gamester, As they do crackers in a puppet-play.
Subtle	If I do give him a familiar, Give you him all you play for; never set him: For he will have it.
	You are mistaken, Doctor.
Face	Why he does ask one but for cups and horses, A rifling fly; none of your great familiars.
Dapper	Yes, Captain, I would have it for all games.
Subtle	I told you so.

Face *Taking DAPPER aside.*
 'Slight, that is a new business!
 I understood you, a tame bird, to fly
 Twice in a term, or so, on Friday nights,
 When you had left the office, for a nag
 Of forty or fifty shillings.

Dapper Ay, 'tis true, sir;
 But I do think now I shall leave the law,
 And therefore—

Face Why, this changes quite the case.
 Do you think that I dare move him?

Dapper If you please, sir;
 All's one to him, I see.
 What! For that money?

Face I cannot with my conscience; nor should you
 Make the request, methinks.

Dapper No, sir, I mean
 To add consideration.
 Why then, sir,

Face I'll try.—
 Goes to SUBTLE.
 Say that it were for all games, Doctor.

Subtle I say then, not a mouth shall eat for him
 At any ordinary, but on the score,
 That is a gaming mouth, conceive me.

Face Indeed!

Subtle He'll draw you all the treasure of the realm,
 If it be set him.

Face Speak you this from art?

 Ay, sir, and reason too, the ground of art.

Subtle He is of the only best complexion,
 The Queen of Fairy loves.

Face What! Is he?

Subtle Peace.
 He'll overhear you. Sir, should she but see him—

Face	What?
Subtle	Do not you tell him.
Face	Will he win at cards too?
	The spirits of dead Holland, living Isaac,
Subtle	You'd swear, were in him; such a vigorous luck As cannot be resisted. 'Slight, he'll put Six of your gallants to a cloak, indeed.
Face	A strange success, that some man shall be born to.
Subtle	He hears you, man—
Dapper	Sir, I'll not be ingrateful.
Face	Faith, I have confidence in his good nature: You hear, he says he will not be ingrateful.
Subtle	Why, as you please; my venture follows yours. Troth, do it, Doctor; think him trusty, and make him.
Face	He may make us both happy in an hour; Win some five thousand pound, and send us two on't.
Dapper	Believe it, and I will, sir. And you shall, sir.
Face	<i>Takes him aside.</i> You have heard all?
Dapper	No, what was't? Nothing, I, sir.
Face	Nothing!
Dapper	A little, sir.
Face	Well, a rare star Reigned at your birth.
Dapper	At mine, sir! No.
Face	The Doctor Swears that you are—
Subtle	Nay, Captain, you'll tell all now.
Face	Allied to the Queen of Fairy.
Dapper	Who! That I am? Believe it, no such matter—
Face	Yes, and that

You were born with a cawl on your head.
 Dapper Who says so?
 Face Come,
 You know it well enough, though you dissemble it.
 Dapper I'fac, I do not; you are mistaken.
 How!
 Swear by your fac, and in a thing so known
 Face Unto the Doctor? How shall we, sir, trust you
 In the other matter? Can we ever think,
 When you have won five or six thousand pound,
 You'll send us shares in't, by this rate?
 By Jove, sir,
 Dapper I'll win ten thousand pound, and send you half.
 I'fac's no oath.
 Subtle No, no, he did but jest.
 Face Go to. Go thank the Doctor: he's your friend,
 To take it so.
 Dapper I thank his worship.
 Face So!
 Another angel.
 Dapper Must I?
 Must you! 'Slight,
 Face What else is thanks? Will you be trivial?—Doctor,
DAPPER gives him the money.
 When must he come for his familiar?
 Dapper Shall I not have it with me?
 O, good sir!
 There must a world of ceremonies pass;
 Subtle You must be bathed and fumigated first:
 Besides the Queen of Fairy does not rise
 Till it be noon.
 Face Not, if she danced, tonight.
 Subtle And she must bless it.
 Face Did you never see

	Her royal Grace yet?
Dapper	Whom?
Face	Your aunt of Fairy?
Subtle	Not since she kissed him in the cradle, Captain; I can resolve you that. Well, see her Grace, Whate'er it cost you, for a thing that I know. It will be somewhat hard to compass; but However, see her. You are made, believe it, Face If you can see her. Her Grace is a lone woman, And very rich; and if she take a fancy, She will do strange things. See her, at any hand. 'Slid, she may hap to leave you all she has: It is the Doctor's fear.
Dapper	How will't be done, then?
Face	Let me alone, take you no thought. Do you But say to me, Captain, I'll see her Grace.
Dapper	"Captain, I'll see her Grace."
Face	Enough. <i>Knocking within.</i> Who's there? Anon. <i>Aside to FACE.</i> —Conduct him forth by the back way.— Sir, against one o'clock prepare yourself; Subtle Till when you must be fasting; only take Three drops of vinegar in at your nose, Two at your mouth, and one at either ear; Then bathe your fingers' ends and wash your eyes, To sharpen your five senses, and cry "hum" Thrice, and then "buz" as often; and then come. <i>Exit.</i>
Face	Can you remember this?
Dapper	I warrant you.
Face	Well then, away. It is but your bestowing

Some twenty nobles 'mong her Grace's servants,
And put on a clean shirt: you do not know
What grace her Grace may do you in clean linen.

Exeunt FACE and DAPPER.

Subtle *Within.* Come in! Good wives, I pray you forbear me now;
Troth I can do you no good till afternoon—

Re-enters, followed by DRUGGER.

What is your name, say you? Abel Drugger?

Drugger Yes, sir.

Subtle A seller of tobacco?

Drugger Yes, sir.

Subtle Umph!
Free of the grocers?

Drugger Ay, and't please you.

Subtle Well—
Your business, Abel?

Drugger This, and't please your worship;
I am a young beginner, and am building
Of a new shop, and't like your worship, just
At corner of a street:—Here is the plot on't—
And I would know by art, sir, of your worship,
Which way I should make my door, by necromancy,
And where my shelves; and which should be for boxes,
And which for pots. I would be glad to thrive, sir:
And I was wished to your worship by a gentleman,
One Captain Face, that says you know men's planets,
And their good angels, and their bad.

Subtle I do,
If I do see them—

Re-enter FACE.

Face What! My honest Abel?
Though art well met here.

Drugger Troth, sir, I was speaking,
Just as your worship came here, of your worship:

	I pray you speak for me to Master Doctor. He shall do anything.—Doctor, do you hear? This is my friend, Abel, an honest fellow; He lets me have good tobacco, and he does not Sophisticate it with sack-lees or oil, Nor washes it in muscadel and grains, Nor buries it in gravel, under ground, Face Wrapped up in greasy leather, or pissed clouts: But keeps it in fine lily pots, that, opened, Smell like conserve of roses, or French beans. He has his maple block, his silver tongs, Winchester pipes, and fire of Juniper: A neat, spruce, honest fellow, and no goldsmith.
Subtle	He is a fortunate fellow, that I am sure on.
Face	Already, sir, have you found it? Lo thee, Abel!
Subtle	And in right way toward riches —
Face	Sir! This summer
Subtle	He will be of the clothing of his company, And next spring called to the scarlet; spend what he can.
Face	What, and so little beard? Sir, you must think,
Subtle	He may have a receipt to make hair come: But he'll be wise, preserve his youth, and fine for't; His fortune looks for him another way.
Face	'Slid, Doctor, how canst thou know this so soon? I am amused at that! By a rule, Captain, In metoposcopy, which I do work by; A certain star in the forehead, which you see not.
Subtle	Your chestnut or your olive-coloured face Does never fail: and your long ear doth promise. I knew't by certain spots, too, in his teeth, And on the nail of his mercurial finger.
Face	Which finger's that?

Subtle His little finger. Look.
 You were born upon a Wednesday?

Drugger Yes, indeed, sir.
 The thumb, in chiromancy, we give Venus;
 The forefinger, to Jove; the midst, to Saturn;
 The ring, to Sol; the least, to Mercury,

Subtle Who was the lord, sir, of his horoscope,
 His house of life being Libra; which foreshowed,
 He should be a merchant, and should trade with balance.

Face Why, this is strange! Is it not, honest Nab?
 There is a ship now, coming from Ormus,
 That shall yield him such a commodity

Subtle Of drugs
 Pointing to the plan.
 —This is the west, and this the south?

Drugger Yes, sir.

Subtle And those are your two sides?

Drugger Ay, sir.
 Make me your door, then, south; your broad side, west:
 And on the east side of your shop, aloft,
 Write Mathlai, Tarmiel, and Baraborat;

Subtle Upon the north part, Rael, Velel, Thiel.
 They are the names of those mercurial spirits,
 That do fright flies from boxes.

Drugger Yes, sir.
 And

Subtle Beneath your threshold, bury me a loadstone
 To draw in gallants that wear spurs: the rest,
 They'll seem to follow.

Face That's a secret, Nab!

 And, on your stall, a puppet, with a vice

Subtle And a court-fucus to call city-dames:
 You shall deal much with minerals.

Drugger Sir, I have.
 At home, already —

Subtle Ay, I know you have arsenic,
 Vitriol, sal-tartar, argaile, alkali,
 Cinoper: I know all.—This fellow, Captain,
 Will come, in time, to be a great distiller,
 And give a say—I will not say directly,
 But very fair—at the philosopher's stone.

Face Why, how now, Abel! Is this true?
 Aside to FACE.

Drugger Good Captain,
 What must I give?
 Nay, I'll not counsel thee.

Face Thou hear'st what wealth (he says, spend what thou canst,) Thou'rt like to come to.

Drugger I would gi' him a crown.

Face A crown! And toward such a fortune? Heart,
 Thou shalt rather gi' him thy shop. No gold about thee?

Drugger Yes, I have a portague, I have kept this half-year.
 Out on thee, Nab! 'Slight, there was such an offer—
 Shalt keep't no longer, I'll give't him for thee. Doctor,

Face Nab prays your worship to drink this, and swears
 He will appear more grateful, as your skill
 Does raise him in the world.

Drugger I would entreat
 Another favour of his worship.

Face What is't, Nab?

 But to look over, sir, my almanack,

Drugger And cross out my ill-days, that I may neither
 Bargain, nor trust upon them.

Face That he shall, Nab:
 Leave it, it shall be done, 'gainst afternoon.

Subtle And a direction for his shelves.

Face Now, Nab,
 Art thou well pleased, Nab?

Drugger 'Thank, sir, both your worships.

Face Away.
Exit DRUGGER.
 Why, now, you smoaky persecutor of nature!
 Now do you see, that something's to be done,
 Beside your beech-coal, and your corsive waters,
 Your crosslets, crucibles, and cucurbites?
 You must have stuff brought home to you, to work on:
 And yet you think, I am at no expense
 In searching out these veins, then following them,
 Then trying them out. 'Fore God, my intelligence
 Costs me more money, than my share oft comes to,
 In these rare works.

Subtle You are pleasant, sir.
Re-enter DOL.
 —How now!
 What says my dainty Dolkin?
 Yonder fishwife

Dol Common Will not away. And there's your giantess,
 The bawd of Lambeth.

Subtle Heart, I cannot speak with them.
 Not afore night, I have told them in a voice,

Dol Common Thorough the trunk, like one of your familiars.
 But I have spied sir Epicure Mammon—

Subtle Where?
 Coming along, at far end of the lane,

Dol Common Slow of his feet, but earnest of his tongue
 To one that's with him.

Subtle Face, go you and shift.
Exit FACE.
 Dol, you must presently make ready, too.

Dol Common Why, what's the matter?

Subtle O, I did look for him
 With the sun's rising: 'marvel he could sleep,
 This is the day I am to perfect for him

The *magisterium*, our great work, the stone;
And yield it, made, into his hands: of which
He has, this month, talked as he were possessed.
And now he's dealing pieces on't away.—
Methinks I see him entering ordinaries,
Dispensing for the pox, and plaguey houses,
Reaching his dose, walking Moorfields for lepers,
And offering citizens' wives pomander-bracelets,
As his preservative, made of the elixir;
Searching the spittal, to make old bawds young;
And the highways, for beggars, to make rich.
I see no end of his labours. He will make
Nature ashamed of her long sleep: when art,
Who's but a step-dame, shall do more than she,
In her best love to mankind, ever could:
If his dream lasts, he'll turn the age to gold.
Exeunt.

ACT II

SCENE I

An outer room in LOVEWIT'S house.

Enter SIR EPICURE MAMMON and SURLY.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Come on, sir. Now, you set your foot on shore
In *Novo Orbe*; here's the rich Peru:
And there within, sir, are the golden mines,
Great Solomon's Ophir! He was sailing to't,
Three years, but we have reached it in ten months.
This is the day, wherein, to all my friends,
I will pronounce the happy word, *Be Rich*;
This day you shall be spectatissimi.
You shall no more deal with the hollow dye,
Or the frail card. No more be at charge of keeping
The livery-punk for the young heir, that must
Seal, at all hours, in his shirt: no more,
If he deny, have him beaten to't, as he is
That brings him the commodity. No more
Shall thirst of satin, or the covetous hunger
Of velvet entrails for a rude-spun cloak,
To be displayed at Madam Augusta's, make
The sons of Sword and Hazard fall before
The golden calf, and on their knees, whole nights
Commit idolatry with wine and trumpets:

Or go a feasting after drum and ensign.
No more of this. You shall start up young viceroys,
And have your punks, and punketees, my Surly.
And unto thee I speak it first, *Be Rich*.
Where is my Subtle, there? Within, ho!
Within.

Face

Sir,
He'll come to you by and by.

That is his firedrake,
His Lungs, his Zephyrus, he that puffs his coals,
Till he firk nature up, in her own centre.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

You are not faithful, sir. This night, I'll change
All that is metal, in my house, to gold:
And, early in the morning, will I send
To all the plumbers and the pewterers,
And by their tin and lead up; and to Lothbury
For all the copper.

Pertinax Surly

What, and turn that too?

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Yes, and I'll purchase Devonshire and Cornwall,
And make them perfect Indies! You admire now?

Pertinax Surly

No, faith.

But when you see th' effects of the Great Medicine,
Of which one part projected on a hundred
Of Mercury, or Venus, or the moon,
Shall turn it to as many of the sun;
Nay, to a thousand, so ad infinitum:
You will believe me.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Yes, when I see't, I will.

Pertinax Surly

But if my eyes do cozen me so, and I
Giving them no occasion, sure I'll have
A whore, shall piss them out next day.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Ha! Why?

Do you think I fable with you? I assure you,
He that has once the flower of the sun,
The perfect ruby, which we call elixir,
Not only can do that, but, by its virtue,

Can confer honour, love, respect, long life;
Give safety, valour, yea, and victory,
To whom he will. In eight and twenty days,
I'll make an old man of fourscore, a child.

Pertinax Surly

No doubt; he's that already.

Nay, I mean,
Restore his years, renew him, like an eagle,
To the fifth age; make him get sons and daughters,
Young giants; as our philosophers have done,
The ancient patriarchs, afore the flood,
But taking, once a week, on a knife's point,
The quantity of a grain of mustard of it;
Become stout Marses, and beget young Cupids.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Pertinax Surly

The decayed Vestals of Pict-hatch would thank you,
That keep the fire alive, there.

'Tis the secret
Of nature naturised 'gainst all infections,
Cures all diseases coming of all causes;
A month's grief in a day, a year's in twelve;
And, of what age soever, in a month:
Past all the doses of your drugging doctors.
I'll undertake, withal, to fright the plague
Out of the kingdom in three months.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Pertinax Surly

And I'll
Be bound, the players shall sing your praises, then,
Without their poets.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Sir, I'll do't. Meantime,
I'll give away so much unto my man,
Shall serve the whole city, with preservative
Weekly; each house his dose, and at the rate—

Pertinax Surly
Sir Epicure
Mammon

As he that built the waterwork, does with water?
You are incredulous.

Pertinax Surly

Faith I have a humour,
I would not willingly be gulled. Your stone

	Cannot transmute me.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Pertinax, [my] Surly, Will you believe antiquity? Records? I'll show you a book where Moses and his sister, And Solomon have written of the art; Ay, and a treatise penned by Adam—
Pertinax Surly	How!
Sir Epicure Mammon	Of the philosopher's stone, and in High Dutch.
Pertinax Surly	Did Adam write, sir, in High Dutch?
Sir Epicure Mammon	He did; Which proves it was the primitive tongue.
Pertinax Surly	What paper?
Sir Epicure Mammon	On cedar board.
Pertinax Surly	O that, indeed, they say, Will last 'gainst worms. 'Tis like your Irish wood, 'Gainst cobwebs. I have a piece of Jason's fleece, too, Which was no other than a book of alchemy, Writ in large sheepskin, a good fat ram-vellum. Such was Pythagoras' thigh, Pandora's tub, And, all that fable of Medea's charms, The manner of our work; the bulls, our furnace, Still breathing fire; our argent-vive, the dragon: The dragon's teeth, mercury sublimate, That keeps the whiteness, hardness, and the biting; And they are gathered into Jason's helm, The alembic, and then sowed in Mars his field, And thence sublimed so often, till they're fixed. Both this, the Hesperian garden, Cadmus' story, Jove's shower, the boon of Midas, Argus' eyes, Boccace his Demogorgon, thousands more, All abstract riddles of our stone.

Enter FACE, as a servant.

	—How now!
	Do we succeed? Is our day come? And holds it?
Face	The evening will set red upon you, sir; You have colour for it, crimson: the red ferment Has done his office; three hours hence prepare you To see projection.
	Pertinax, my Surly.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Again I say to thee, aloud, <i>Be rich</i> . This day, thou shalt have ingots; and tomorrow, Give lords th' affront.—Is it, my Zephyrus, right? Blushes the bolt's head?
Face	Like a wench with child, sir, That were but now discovered to her master.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Excellent witty Lungs!—my only care Where to get stuff enough now, to project on; This town will not half serve me.
Face	No, sir! Buy The covering off o' churches.
Sir Epicure Mammon	That's true.
	Yes.
Face	Let them stand bare, as do their auditory; Or cap them, new, with shingles.
	No, good thatch:
Sir Epicure Mammon	Thatch will lie light upon the rafters, Lungs.— Lungs, I will manumit thee from the furnace; I will restore thee thy complexion, Puffe, Lost in the embers; and repair this brain, Hurt with the fume o' the metals.
Face	I have blown, sir, Hard for your worship; thrown by many a coal, When 'twas not beech; weighed those I put in, just, To keep your heat still even; these bleared eyes Have waked to read your several colours, sir,

	Of the pale citron, the green lion, the crow, The peacock's tail, the plumed swan.
Sir Epicure	And, lastly,
Mammon	Thou hast descryed the flower, the <i>sanguis agni</i> ?
Face	Yes, sir.
Sir Epicure	Where's master?
Mammon	
	At his prayers, sir, he;
Face	Good man, he's doing his devotions For the success.
	Lungs, I will set a period
Sir Epicure	To all thy labours; thou shalt be the master
Mammon	Of my seraglio.
Face	Good, sir.
Sir Epicure	But do you hear?
Mammon	I'll geld you, Lungs.
Face	Yes, sir.
	For I do mean
	To have a list of wives and concubines,
Sir Epicure	Equal with Solomon, who had the stone
Mammon	Alike with me; and I will make me a back With the elixir, that shall be as tough As Hercules, to encounter fifty a night.— Thou'rt sure thou saw'st it blood?
Face	Both blood and spirit, sir.
Sir Epicure	I will have all my beds blown up, not stuffed;
Mammon	Down is too hard: and then, mine oval room Filled with such pictures as Tiberius took From Elephantis, and dull Aretine But coldly imitated. Then, my glasses Cut in more subtle angles, to disperse And multiply the figures, as I walk Naked between my succubae. My mists I'll have of perfume, vapoured 'bout the room, To lose ourselves in; and my baths, like pits

Face
Sir Epicure
Mammon

To fall into; from whence we will come forth,
And roll us dry in gossamer and roses.—
Is it arrived at ruby?— Where I spy
A wealthy citizen, or [a] rich lawyer,
Have a sublimed pure wife, unto that fellow
I'll send a thousand pound to be my cuckold.
And I shall carry it?
No. I'll have no bawds,
But fathers and mothers: they will do it best,
Best of all others. And my flatterers
Shall be the pure and gravest of divines,
That I can get for money. My mere fools,
Eloquent burgesses, and then my poets
The same that writ so subtly of the fart,
Whom I will entertain still for that subject.
The few that would give out themselves to be
Court and town-stallions, and, each-where, bely
Ladies who are known most innocent for them;
Those will I beg, to make me eunuchs of:
And they shall fan me with ten ostrich tails
Apiece, made in a plume to gather wind.
We will be brave, Puffe, now we have the medicine.
My meat shall all come in, in Indian shells,
Dishes of agate set in gold, and studded
With emeralds, sapphires, hyacinths, and rubies.
The tongues of carps, dormice, and camels' heels,
Boiled in the spirit of Sol, and dissolved pearl,
Apicius' diet, 'gainst the epilepsy:
And I will eat these broths with spoons of amber,
Headed with diamond and carbuncle.
My footboy shall eat pheasants, calvered salmons,
Knots, godwits, lampreys: I myself will have
The beards of barbels served, instead of salads;
Oiled mushrooms; and the swelling unctuous paps
Of a fat pregnant sow, newly cut off,
Dressed with an exquisite, and poignant sauce;

For which, I'll say unto my cook, "There's gold,
Go forth, and be a knight."

Face

Sir, I'll go look
A little, how it heightens.

Exit.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Do.—My shirts
I'll have of taffeta-sarsnet, soft and light
As cobwebs; and for all my other raiment,
It shall be such as might provoke the Persian,
Were he to teach the world riot anew.
My gloves of fishes' and birds' skins, perfumed
With gums of paradise, and eastern air—

Pertinax Surly
Sir Epicure
Mammon

And do you think to have the stone with this?

No, I do think t' have all this with the stone.

Pertinax Surly

Why, I have heard he must be *homo frugi*,
A pious, holy, and religious man,
One free from mortal sin, a very virgin.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

That makes it, sir; he is so; but I buy it;
My venture brings it me. He, honest wretch,
A notable, superstitious, good soul,
Has worn his knees bare, and his slippers bald,
With prayer and fasting for it: and, sir, let him
Do it alone, for me, still. Here he comes.
Not a profane word afore him: 'tis poison.—

Enter SUBTLE.

Good morrow, Father.

Subtle

Gentle son, good morrow,
And to your friend there. What is he, is with you?

Sir Epicure
Mammon

An heretic, that I did bring along,
In hope, sir, to convert him.

Subtle

Son, I doubt
You are covetous, that thus you meet your time
In the just point: prevent your day at morning.
This argues something, worthy of a fear

Of importune and carnal appetite.
Take heed you do not cause the blessing leave you,
With your ungoverned haste. I should be sorry
To see my labours, now even at perfection,
Got by long watching and large patience,
Not prosper where my love and zeal hath placed them.
Which (heaven I call to witness, with yourself,
To whom I have poured my thoughts) in all my ends,
Have looked no way, but unto public good,
To pious uses, and dear charity
Now grown a prodigy with men. Wherein
If you, my son, should now prevaricate,
And, to your own particular lusts employ
So great and catholic a bliss, be sure
A curse will follow, yea, and overtake
Your subtle and most secret ways.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

I know, sir;
You shall not need to fear me; I but come,
To have you confute this gentleman.

Pertinax Surly

Who is,
Indeed, sir, somewhat costive of belief
Toward your stone; would not be gulled.

Subtle

Well, son,
All that I can convince him in, is this,
The work is done, bright Sol is in his robe.
We have a medicine of the triple soul,
The glorified spirit. Thanks be to heaven,
And make us worthy of it! — Ulen Spiegel!

Face

Within. Anon, sir.

Subtle

Look well to the register.
And let your heat still lessen by degrees,
To the aludels.

Face

Within. Yes, sir.

Subtle

Did you look
On the bolt's head yet?

Face

Within. Which? On D, sir?

Subtle	Ay; What's the complexion?
Face	<i>Within.</i> Whitish. Infuse vinegar, To draw his volatile substance and his tincture:
Subtle	And let the water in glass E be filtered, And put into the gripe's egg. Lute him well; And leave him closed in balneo.
Face	<i>Within.</i> I will, sir.
Pertinax Surly	What a brave language here is! Next to canting. I have another work, you never saw, son, That three days since past the philosopher's wheel, In the lent heat of Athanor; and's become Sulphur of Nature.
Sir Epicure Mammon	But 'tis for me?
Subtle	What need you? You have enough in that is perfect.
Sir Epicure Mammon	O but—
Subtle	Why, this is covetise! No, I assure you, I shall employ it all in pious uses, Founding of colleges and grammar schools, Marrying young virgins, building hospitals, And now and then a church.
	<i>Re-enter FACE.</i>
Subtle	How now!
Face	Sir, please you, Shall I not change the filter?
Subtle	Marry, yes; And bring me the complexion of glass B. <i>Exit FACE.</i>
Sir Epicure	Have you another?

Mammon

Yes, son; were I assured—

Subtle

Your piety were firm, we would not want
The means to glorify it: but I hope the best.—
I mean to tinct C in sand-heat tomorrow,
And give him imbibition.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Of white oil?

Subtle

No, sir, of red. F is come over the helm too,
I thank my Maker, in St. Mary's bath,
And shows *lac virginis*. Blessed be heaven!
I sent you of his faeces there calcined:
Out of that calx, I have won the salt of mercury.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

By pouring on your rectified water?

Subtle

Yes, and reverberating in Athanor.

Re-enter FACE.

How now! What colour says it?

Face

The ground black, sir.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

That's your crow's head?

Pertinax Surly

Your cockscomb's, is it not?

Subtle

No, 'tis not perfect. Would it were the crow!
That work wants something.

Pertinax Surly

Aside. O, I looked for this.
The hay's a pitching.

Subtle

Are you sure you loosed them
In their own menstree?

Yes, sir, and then married them,
And put them in a bolt's head nipped to digestion,
According as you bade me, when I set
The liquor of Mars to circulation
In the same heat.

Subtle

The process then was right.

Face	Yes, by the token, sir, the retort brake, And what was saved was put into the pelican, And signed with Hermes' seal.
Subtle	I think 'twas so. We should have a new amalgama.
Pertinax Surly	<i>Aside.</i> O, this ferret Is rank as any polecat.
Subtle	But I care not: Let him e'en die; we have enough beside, In embrion. H has his white shirt on?
Face	Yes, sir, He's ripe for inceration, he stands warm, In his ash-fire. I would not you should let Any die now, if I might counsel, sir, For luck's sake to the rest: it is not good.
Sir Epicure Mammon	He says right.
Pertinax Surly	<i>Aside.</i> Ay, are you bolted?
Face	Nay, I know't, sir, I have seen the ill fortune. What is some three ounces Of fresh materials?
Sir Epicure Mammon	Is't no more?
Face	No more, sir. Of gold, t'amalgam with some six of mercury.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Away, here's money. What will serve?
Face	Ask him, sir.
Sir Epicure Mammon	How much?
Subtle	Give him nine pound:—you may give him ten.
Pertinax Surly	Yes, twenty, and be cozened, do.
Sir Epicure Mammon	There 'tis. <i>Gives FACE the money.</i>

Subtle	This needs not; but that you will have it so, To see conclusions of all: for two Of our inferior works are at fixation, A third is in ascension. Go your ways. Have you set the oil of luna in kemia?
Face	Yes, sir.
Subtle	And the philosopher's vinegar?
Face	Ay. <i>Exit.</i>
Pertinax Surly	We shall have a salad!
Sir Epicure Mammon	When do you make projection?
	Son, be not hasty, I exalt our medicine, By hanging him in <i>balneo vaporoso</i> , And giving him solution; then congeal him; And then dissolve him; then again congeal him; For look, how oft I iterate the work, So many times I add unto his virtue. As, if at first one ounce convert a hundred, After his second loose, he'll turn a thousand; His third solution, ten; his fourth, a hundred: After his fifth, a thousand thousand ounces Of any imperfect metal, into pure Silver or gold, in all examinations, As good as any of the natural mine. Get you your stuff here against afternoon, Your brass, your pewter, and your andirons.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Not those of iron?
Subtle	Yes, you may bring them too: We'll change all metals.
Pertinax Surly	I believe you in that.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Then I may send my spits?
Subtle	Yes, and your racks.

Pertinax Surly	And dripping-pans, and pot-hangers, and hooks? Shall he not?
Subtle	If he please.
Pertinax Surly	—To be an ass.
Subtle	How, sir!
Sir Epicure	This gentleman you must bear withal:
Mammon	I told you he had no faith.
Pertinax Surly	And little hope, sir; But much less charity, should I gull myself.
Subtle	Why, what have you observed, sir, in our art, Seems so impossible? But your whole work, no more.
Pertinax Surly	That you should hatch gold in a furnace, sir, As they do eggs in Egypt!
Subtle	Sir, do you Believe that eggs are hatched so?
Pertinax Surly	If I should? Why, I think that the greater miracle.
Subtle	No egg but differs from a chicken more Than metals in themselves. That cannot be.
Pertinax Surly	The egg's ordained by nature to that end, And is a chicken <i>in potentia</i> .
Subtle	The same we say of lead and other metals, Which would be gold, if they had time.
Sir Epicure	And that
Mammon	Our art doth further. Ay, for 'twere absurd
Subtle	To think that nature in the earth bred gold Perfect in the instant: something went before. There must be remote matter.
Pertinax Surly	Ay, what is that?
Subtle	Marry, we say—
Sir Epicure	Ay, now it heats: stand, Father,

Mammon

Pound him to dust.

It is, of the one part,
A humid exhalation, which we call
Materia liquida, or the unctuous water;
On the other part, a certain crass and vicious
Portion of earth; both which, concorporate,
Do make the elementary matter of gold;
Which is not yet *propria materia*,
But common to all metals and all stones;
For, where it is forsaken of that moisture,
And hath more dryness, it becomes a stone:
Where it retains more of the humid fatness,
It turns to sulphur, or to quicksilver,
Who are the parents of all other metals.
Nor can this remote matter suddenly
Progress so from extreme unto extreme,
As to grow gold, and leap o'er all the means.
Nature doth first beget the imperfect, then
Proceeds she to the perfect. Of that airy
And oily water, mercury is engendered;
Sulphur of the fat and earthy part; the one,
Which is the last, supplying the place of male,
The other of the female, in all metals.
Some do believe hermaphrodeity,
That both do act and suffer. But these two
Make the rest ductile, malleable, extensive.
And even in gold they are; for we do find
Seeds of them, by our fire, and gold in them;
And can produce the species of each metal
More perfect thence, than nature doth in earth.
Beside, who doth not see in daily practice
Art can beget bees, hornets, beetles, wasps,
Out of the carcasses and dung of creatures;
Yea, scorpions of an herb, being rightly placed?
And these are living creatures, far more perfect
And excellent than metals.

Sir Epicure

Well said, Father!

Mammon	Nay, if he take you in hand, sir, with an argument, He'll bray you in a mortar. Pray you, sir, stay. Rather than I'll be brayed, sir, I'll believe
Pertinax Surly	That Alchemy is a pretty kind of game, Somewhat like tricks o' the cards, to cheat a man With charming.
Subtle	Sir? What else are all your terms, Whereon no one of your writers 'grees with other? Of your elixir, your <i>lac virginis</i> , Your stone, your medicine, and your chrysosperm, Your sal, your sulphur, and your mercury, Your oil of height, your tree of life, your blood, Your marcasite, your tutie, your magnesia, Your toad, your crow, your dragon, and your panther;
Pertinax Surly	Your sun, your moon, your firmament, your adrop, Your lato, azoch, zernich, chibrit, heautarit, And then your red man, and your white woman, With all your broths, your menstrues, and materials, Of piss and eggshells, women's terms, man's blood, Hair o' the head, burnt clouts, chalk, merds, and clay, Powder of bones, scalings of iron, glass, And worlds of other strange ingredients, Would burst a man to name?
Subtle	And all these named, Intending but one thing; which art our writers Used to obscure their art.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Sir, so I told him— Because the simple idiot should not learn it, And make it vulgar.
Subtle	Was not all the knowledge Of the Egyptians writ in mystic symbols? Speak not the scriptures oft in parables? Are not the choicest fables of the poets,

	That were the fountains and first springs of wisdom, Wrapped in perplexed allegories?
Sir Epicure Mammon	I urged that, And cleared to him, that Sisyphus was damned To roll the ceaseless stone, only because He would have made Ours common.
Dol Common	<i>Appears at the door.—</i> Who is this?
Subtle	'Sprecious!—What do you mean? Go in, good lady, Let me entreat you. <i>DOL retires.</i> —Where's this varlet? <i>Re-enter FACE.</i>
Face	Sir.
Subtle	You very knave! Do you use me thus?
Face	Wherein, sir?
Subtle	Go in and see, you traitor. Go! <i>Exit FACE.</i>
Sir Epicure Mammon	Who is it, sir?
Subtle	Nothing, sir; nothing.
Sir Epicure Mammon	What's the matter, good sir? I have not seen you thus distempered: who is't?
Subtle	All arts have still had, sir, their adversaries; But ours the most ignorant.— <i>Re-enter FACE.</i> What now?
Face	'Twas not my fault, sir; she would speak with you.
Subtle	Would she, sir! Follow me. <i>Exit.</i>
Sir Epicure Mammon	<i>Stopping him.</i> Stay, Lungs.
Face	I dare not, sir.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Stay, man; what is she?

Face

A lord's sister, sir.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

How! Pray thee, stay.

Face

She's mad, sir, and sent hither —
He'll be mad too. —

Sir Epicure
Mammon

I warrant thee. —
Why sent hither?

Face

Sir, to be cured.

Subtle

Within. Why, rascal!

Face

Lo you! — Here, sir!

Exit.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

'Fore God, a Bradamante, a brave piece.

Pertinax Surly

Heart, this is a bawdyhouse! I will be burnt else.

O, by this light, no: do not wrong him. He's
Too scrupulous that way: it is his vice.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

No, he's a rare physician, do him right,
An excellent Paracelsian, and has done
Strange cures with mineral physic. He deals all
With spirits, he; he will not hear a word
Of Galen; or his tedious recipes. —

Re-enter FACE.

How now, Lungs!

Face

Softly, sir; speak softly. I meant
To have told your worship all. This must not hear.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

No, he will not be "gulled;" let him alone.

Face

You are very right, sir, she is a most rare scholar,
And is gone mad with studying Broughton's works.
If you but name a word touching the Hebrew,
She falls into her fit, and will discourse

	So learnedly of genealogies, As you would run mad too, to hear her, sir.
Sir Epicure Mammon	How might one do t' have conference with her, Lungs?
Face	O divers have run mad upon the conference: I do not know, sir. I am sent in haste, To fetch a vial.
Pertinax Surly	Be not gulled, Sir Mammon.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Wherein? Pray ye, be patient.
Pertinax Surly	Yes, as you are, And trust confederate knaves and bawds and whores.
Sir Epicure Mammon	You are too foul, believe it.—Come here, Ulen, One word.
Face	I dare not, in good faith. <i>Going.</i>
Sir Epicure Mammon	Stay, knave.
Face	He is extreme angry that you saw her, sir.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Drink that. <i>Gives him money.</i> What is she when she's out of her fit?
Face	O, the most affablest creature, sir! So merry! So pleasant! She'll mount you up, like quicksilver, Over the helm; and circulate like oil, A very vegetal: discourse of state, Of mathematics, bawdry, anything—
Sir Epicure Mammon	Is she no way accessible? No means, No trick to give a man a taste of her—wit— Or so?
Subtle	<i>Within.</i> Ulen!
Face	I'll come to you again, sir. <i>Exit.</i>
Sir Epicure Mammon	Surly, I did not think one of your breeding Would traduce personages of worth.

Pertinax Surly	Sir Epicure, Your friend to use; yet still loth to be gulled: I do not like your philosophical bawds. Their stone is letchery enough to pay for, Without this bait. 'Heart, you abuse yourself.
Sir Epicure Mammon	I know the lady, and her friends, and means, The original of this disaster. Her brother Has told me all.
Pertinax Surly	And yet you never saw her Till now!
Sir Epicure Mammon	O yes, but I forgot. I have, believe it, One of the treacherousest memories, I do think, Of all mankind.
Pertinax Surly	What call you her brother?
Sir Epicure Mammon	My lord— He will not have his name known, now I think on't.
Pertinax Surly	A very treacherous memory!
Sir Epicure Mammon	On my faith—
Pertinax Surly	Tut, if you have it not about you, pass it, Till we meet next.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Nay, by this hand, 'tis true. He's one I honour, and my noble friend; And I respect his house.
Pertinax Surly	Heart! Can it be, That a grave sir, a rich, that has no need, A wise sir, too, at other times, should thus, With his own oaths, and arguments, make hard means To gull himself? An this be your elixir, Your <i>lapis mineralis</i>, and your lunar, y, Give me your honest trick yet at primero, Or gleek; and take your <i>lutum sapientis</i>, Your <i>menstruum simplex</i>! I'll have gold before you,

And with less danger of the quicksilver,
Or the hot sulphur.

Re-enter FACE.

Here's one from Captain Face, sir,

To SURLY.

Desires you meet him in the Temple-church,
Some half-hour hence, and upon earnest business.

Whispers to MAMMON.

Face

Sir, if you please to quit us, now; and come
Again within two hours, you shall have
My master busy examining o' the works;
And I will steal you in, unto the party,
That you may see her converse.—Sir, shall I say,
You'll meet the Captain's worship?

Sir, I will.—

Walks aside.

But, by attorney, and to a second purpose.

Now, I am sure it is a bawdyhouse;

I'll swear it, were the Marshal here to thank me:

The naming this Commander doth confirm it.

Don Face! Why, he's the most authentic dealer

In these commodities, the superintendant

Pertinax Surly

To all the quainter traffickers in town!

He is the visitor, and does appoint,

Who lies with whom, and at what hour; what price;

Which gown, and in what smock; what fall; what tire.

Him will I prove, by a third person, to find

The subtleties of this dark labyrinth:

Which if I do discover, dear Sir Mammon,

You'll give your poor friend leave, though no philo-
sopher,

To laugh: for you that are, 'tis thought, shall weep.

Face

Sir, he does pray, you'll not forget.

Pertinax Surly

I will not, sir.

Sir Epicure, I shall leave you.

Exit.

Sir Epicure Mammon	I follow you, straight.
Face	But do so, good sir, to avoid suspicion. This gentleman has a parlous head.
Sir Epicure Mammon	But wilt thou Ulen, Be constant to thy promise?
Face	As my life, sir.
Sir Epicure Mammon	And wilt thou insinuate what I am, and praise me, And say, I am a noble fellow?
Face	O, what else, sir? And that you'll make her royal with the stone, An empress; and yourself, King of Bantam.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Wilt thou do this?
Face	Will I, sir!
Sir Epicure Mammon	Lungs, my Lungs! I love thee.
Face	Send your stuff, sir, that my master May busy himself about projection.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Thou hast witched me, rogue: take, go. <i>Gives him money.</i>
Face	Your jack, and all, sir.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Thou art a villain—I will send my jack, And the weights too. Slave, I could bite thine ear. Away, thou dost not care for me.
Face	Not I, sir!
Sir Epicure Mammon	Come, I was born to make thee, my good weasel, Set thee on a bench, and have thee twirl a chain With the best lord's vermin of 'em all.
Face	Away, sir.
Sir Epicure Mammon	A count, nay, a count palatine—
Face	Good, sir, go.
Sir Epicure	Shall not advance thee better: no, nor faster.

Mammon

Exit.

Re-enter SUBTLE and DOL.

Subtle Has he bit? Has he bit?

Face And swallowed, too, my Subtle.
I have given him line, and now he plays, i'faith.

Subtle And shall we twitch him?

Thorough both the gills.

Face A wench is a rare bait, with which a man
No sooner's taken, but he straight firks mad.

Subtle Dol, my Lord What'ts' hums sister, you must now
Bear yourself *statelich*.

O let me alone.

I'll not forget my race, I warrant you.

Dol Common I'll keep my distance, laugh and talk aloud;
Have all the tricks of a proud scurvy lady,
And be as rude as her woman.

Face Well said, sanguine!

Subtle But will he send his andirons?

His jack too,

Face And's iron shoeing-horn; I have spoke to him. Well,
I must not lose my wary gamester yonder.

Subtle O Monsieur Caution, that *will not be gulled*?

Ay,

If I can strike a fine hook into him, now!

Face The Temple-church, there I have cast mine angle.
Well, pray for me. I'll about it.

Knocking without.

What, more gudgeons!

Dol, scout, scout!

Subtle *DOL goes to the window.*

Stay, Face, you must go to the door,
'Pray God it be my Anabaptist—Who is't, Dol?

Dol Common I know him not: he looks like a gold-endman.

	Know you the <i>sapor pontic</i> ? <i>Sapor stiptic</i> ?
	Or what is homogene, or heterogene?
Ananias	I understand no heathen language, truly.
	Heathen! You Knipper-doling? Is <i>Ars sacra</i> ,
Subtle	Or chrysopoeia, or spagyrica,
	Or the pamphysic, or panarchic knowledge,
	A heathen language?
Ananias	Heathen Greek, I take it.
Subtle	How! Heathen Greek?
Ananias	All's heathen but the Hebrew.
	Sirrah, my varlet, stand you forth and speak to him,
Subtle	Like a philosopher: answer in the language.
	Name the vexations, and the martyrisations
	Of metals in the work.
	Sir, putrefaction,
Face	Solution, ablution, sublimation,
	Cohobation, calcination, ceration, and
	Fixation.
Subtle	This is heathen Greek to you, now!—
	And when comes vivification?
Face	After mortification.
Subtle	What's cohobation?
	'Tis the pouring on
Face	Your <i>aqua regis</i> , and then drawing him off,
	To the trine circle of the seven spheres.
Subtle	What's the proper passion of metals?
Face	Malleation.
Subtle	What's your <i>ultimum supplicium auri</i> ?
Face	Antimonium.
Subtle	This is heathen Greek to you!—And what's your mer-
	cury?
Face	A very fugitive, he will be gone, sir.
Subtle	How know you him?
Face	By his viscosity,

Subtle His oleosity, and his suscitability.
 Subtle How do you sublime him?
 Face With the calce of eggshells,
 White marble, talc.
 Subtle Your magisterium now,
 What's that?
 Face Shifting, sir, your elements,
 Dry into cold, cold into moist, moist into hot,
 Hot into dry.
 Subtle This is heathen Greek to you still!
 Your *lapis philosophicus*?
 'Tis a stone,
 Face And not a stone; a spirit, a soul, and a body:
 Which if you do dissolve, it is dissolved;
 If you coagulate, it is coagulated;
 If you make it to fly, it flieth.
 Subtle Enough.
 Exit FACE.
 This is heathen Greek to you! What are you, sir?
 Please you, a servant of the exiled Brethren,
 Ananias That deal with widows' and with orphans' goods,
 And make a just account unto the Saints:
 A Deacon.
 Subtle O, you are sent from master Wholesome,
 Your teacher?
 Ananias From Tribulation Wholesome,
 Our very zealous pastor.
 Subtle Good! I have
 Some orphans' goods to come here.
 Ananias Of what kind, sir?
 Pewter and brass, andirons and kitchenware,
 Subtle Metals, that we must use our medicine on:
 Wherein the Brethren may have a pennyworth
 For ready money.

Ananias Were the orphans' parents
Sincere professors?

Subtle Why do you ask?

 Because

Ananias We then are to deal justly, and give, in truth,
Their utmost value.

 'Slid, you'd cozen else,
And if their parents were not of the faithful! —

Subtle I will not trust you, now I think on it,
'Till I have talked with your pastor. Have you brought
money
To buy more coals?

Ananias No, surely.

Subtle No! How so?

 The Brethren bid me say unto you, sir,
Surely, they will not venture any more,
Till they may see projection.

Subtle How!

 You have had,
For the instruments, as bricks, and loam, and glasses,
Already thirty pound; and for materials,

Ananias They say, some ninety more: and they have heard
since,
That one at Heidelberg, made it of an egg,
And a small paper of pin-dust.

Subtle What's your name?

Ananias My name is Ananias.

Subtle Out, the varlet
That cozened the Apostles! Hence, away!
Flee, mischief! Had your holy Consistory
No name to send me, of another sound,
Than wicked Ananias? Send your elders
Hither to make atonement for you quickly,
And give me satisfaction; or out goes
The fire; and down th' alembics, and the furnace,

Piger Henricus, or whatnot. Thou wretch!
Both sericon and bufo shall be lost,
Tell them. All hope of rooting out the Bishops,
Or the antichristian hierarchy, shall perish,
If they stay threescore minutes: the aqueity,
Terreity, and sulphureity
Shall run together again, and all be annulled,
Thou wicked Ananias!

Exit ANANIAS.

This will fetch 'em,
And make them haste towards their gulling more.
A man must deal like a rough nurse, and fright
Those that are froward, to an appetite.

Re-enter FACE, in his uniform, followed by DRUGGER.

Face

He is busy with his spirits, but we'll upon him.

Subtle

How now! What mates, what Baiards have we here?

Face

I told you, he would be furious.—Sir, here's Nab,
Has brought you another piece of gold to look on:
—We must appease him. Give it me—and prays you,
You would devise—what is it, Nab?

Drugger

A sign, sir.

Face

Ay, a good lucky one, a thriving sign, Doctor.

Subtle

I was devising now.

Face

'Slight, do not say so,
He will repent he gave you any more—
What say you to his constellation, Doctor,
The Balance?

Subtle

No, that way is stale, and common.
A townsman born in Taurus, gives the bull,
Or the bull's-head: in Aries, the ram,
A poor device! No, I will have his name
Formed in some mystic character; whose radii,
Striking the senses of the passers by,
Shall, by a virtual influence, breed affections,

That may result upon the party owns it:
As thus —

Face Nab!
He shall have “a bell,” that’s “Abel;”
And by it standing one whose name is “Dee,”

Subtle In a “rug” gown, there’s “D,” and “Rug,” that’s “drug:”
And right anenst him a dog snarling “er;”
There’s “Drugger,” Abel Drugger. That’s his sign.
And here’s now mystery and hieroglyphic!

Face Abel, thou art made.

Drugger Sir, I do thank his worship.

Face Six o’ thy legs more will not do it, Nab.
He has brought you a pipe of tobacco, Doctor.

Drugger Yes, sir;
I have another thing I would impart —

Face Out with it, Nab.

Drugger Sir, there is lodged, hard by me,
A rich young widow —

Face Good! A bona roba?

Drugger But nineteen, at the most.

Face Very good, Abel.

Drugger Marry, she’s not in fashion yet; she wears
A hood, but it stands a cop.

Face No matter, Abel.

Drugger And I do now and then give her a fucus —

Face What! Dost thou deal, Nab?

Subtle I did tell you, Captain.
And physic too, sometime, sir; for which she trusts me
With all her mind. She’s come up here of purpose
To learn the fashion.

Drugger

Face Good (his match too!)—On, Nab.

Drugger And she does strangely long to know her fortune.

Face Ods lid, Nab, send her to the Doctor, hither.

Drugger	Yes, I have spoke to her of his worship already; But she's afraid it will be blown abroad, And hurt her marriage. Hurt it! 'Tis the way To heal it, if 'twere hurt; to make it more Followed and sought: Nab, thou shalt tell her this. She'll be more known, more talked of; and your wid-
Face	ows Are ne'er of any price till they be famous; Their honour is their multitude of suitors. Send her, it may be thy good fortune. What! Thou dost not know.
Drugger	No, sir, she'll never marry Under a knight: her brother has made a vow. What! And dost thou despair, my little Nab, Knowing what the Doctor has set down for thee,
Face	And seeing so many of the city dubbed? One glass o' thy water, with a Madam I know, Will have it done, Nab: what's her brother, a knight? No, sir, a gentleman newly warm in his land, sir, Scarce cold in his one and twenty, that does govern His sister here; and is a man himself
Drugger	Of some three thousand a year, and is come up To learn to quarrel, and to live by his wits, And will go down again, and die in the country.
Face	How! To quarrel?
Drugger	Yes, sir, to carry quarrels, As gallants do; to manage them by line.
Face	'Slid, Nab, the Doctor is the only man In Christendom for him. He has made a table, With mathematical demonstrations, Touching the art of quarrels: he will give him An instrument to quarrel by. Go, bring them both, Him and his sister. And, for thee, with her The Doctor haply may persuade. Go to:

'Shalt give his worship a new damask suit
Upon the premises.

Subtle O, good Captain!

He shall;

Face He is the honestest fellow, Doctor.— Stay not,
No offers; bring the damask, and the parties.

Drugger I'll try my power, sir.

Face And thy will too, Nab.

Subtle 'Tis good tobacco, this! What is't an ounce?

Face He'll send you a pound, Doctor.

Subtle O no.

He will do't.

Face It is the goodest soul! — Abel, about it.
Thou shalt know more anon. Away, be gone.

Exit DRUGGER.

A miserable rogue, and lives with cheese,
And has the worms. That was the cause, indeed,
Why he came now: he dealt with me in private,
To get a medicine for them.

Subtle And shall, sir. This works.

A wife, a wife for one on us, my dear Subtle!

Face We'll e'en draw lots, and he that fails, shall have
The more in goods, the other has in tail.

Subtle Rather the less: for she may be so light
She may want grains.

Face Ay, or be such a burden,
A man would scarce endure her for the whole.

Subtle Faith, best let's see her first, and then determine.

Face Content: but Dol must have no breath on't.

Subtle Mum.
Away you, to your Surly yonder, catch him.

Face 'Pray God I have not stayed too long.

Subtle I fear it.

Exeunt.

ACT III

SCENE I

The lane before LOVEWIT's house.

Enter TRIBULATION WHOLESOME and ANANIAS.

Tribulation
Wholesome These chastisements are common to the saints,
And such rebukes, we of the separation
Must bear with willing shoulders, as the trials
Sent forth to tempt our frailties.

Ananias In pure zeal,
I do not like the man; he is a heathen,
And speaks the language of Canaan, truly.

Tribulation
Wholesome I think him a profane person indeed.

Ananias He bears
The visible mark of the beast in his forehead.
And for his stone, it is a work of darkness,
And with philosophy blinds the eyes of man.

Tribulation
Wholesome Good brother, we must bend unto all means,
That may give furtherance to the holy cause.

Ananias Which his cannot: the sanctified cause
Should have a sanctified course.

Tribulation
Wholesome Not always necessary:
The children of perdition are oft-times

Made instruments even of the greatest works:
 Beside, we should give somewhat to man's nature,
 The place he lives in, still about the fire,
 And fume of metals, that intoxicate
 The brain of man, and make him prone to passion.
 Where have you greater atheists than your cooks?
 Or more profane, or choleric, than your glass-men?
 More antichristian than your bell-founders?
 What makes the Devil so devilish, I would ask you,
 Satan, our common enemy, but his being
 Perpetually about the fire, and boiling
 Brimstone and arsenic? We must give, I say,
 Unto the motives, and the stirrers up
 Of humours in the blood. It may be so,
 When as the work is done, the stone is made,
 This heat of his may turn into a zeal,
 And stand up for the beauteous discipline,
 Against the menstruous cloth and rag of Rome.
 We must await his calling, and the coming
 Of the good spirit. You did fault, t' upbraid him
 With the Brethren's blessing of Heidelberg, weigh-
 ing
 What need we have to hasten on the work,
 For the restoring of the silenced saints,
 Which ne'er will be, but by the philosopher's stone.
 And so a learned elder, one of Scotland,
 Assured me; *aurum potabile* being
 The only medicine, for the civil magistrate,
 T' incline him to a feeling of the cause;
 And must be daily used in the disease.
 I have not edified more, truly, by man;
 Not since the beautiful light first shone on me:
 And I am sad my zeal hath so offended.

Ananias

Tribulation
Wholesome

Ananias

Let us call on him then.

The motion's good,
 And of the spirit; I will knock first.

Knocks.

Peace be within!

The door is opened, and they enter.

SCENE II

A room in LOVEWIT'S house.

Enter SUBTLE, followed by TRIBULATION and ANANIAS.

Subtle

O, are you come? 'Twas time. Your threescore minutes
Were at last thread, you see: and down had gone

Furnus acediae, turris circulatorius:

Lembec, bolt's head, retort and pelican
Had all been cinders.— Wicked Ananias!
Art thou returned? Nay then, it goes down yet.

Tribulation
Wholesome

Sir, be appeased; he is come to humble
Himself in spirit, and to ask your patience,
If too much zeal hath carried him aside
From the due path.

Subtle

Why, this doth qualify!

Tribulation
Wholesome

The Brethren had no purpose, verily,
To give you the least grievance; but are ready
To lend their willing hands to any project
The spirit and you direct.

Subtle

This qualifies more!

Tribulation
Wholesome

And for the orphans' goods, let them be valued,
Or what is needful else to the holy work,
It shall be numbered; here, by me, the Saints,
Throw down their purse before you.

Subtle

This qualifies most!
Why, thus it should be, now you understand.

Have I discoursed so unto you of our stone,
 And of the good that it shall bring your cause?
 Showed you (beside the main of hiring forces
 Abroad, drawing the Hollanders, your friends,
 From the Indies, to serve you, with all their fleet)
 That even the medicinal use shall make you a faction,
 And party in the realm? As, put the case,
 That some great man in state, he have the gout,
 Why, you but send three drops of your elixir,
 You help him straight: there you have made a friend.
 Another has the palsy or the dropsy,
 He takes of your incombustible stuff,
 He's young again: there you have made a friend,
 A lady that is past the feat of body,
 Though not of mind, and hath her face decayed
 Beyond all cure of paintings, you restore,
 With the oil of talc: there you have made a friend;
 And all her friends. A lord that is a leper,
 A knight that has the bone-ache, or a squire
 That hath both these, you make them smooth and
 sound,
 With a bare fricace of your medicine: still
 You increase your friends.

Tribulation
 Wholesome

Ay, it is very pregnant.

Subtle

And then the turning of this lawyer's pewter
 To plate at Christmas.—

Ananias

Christ-tide, I pray you.

Subtle

Yet, Ananias!

Ananias

I have done.

Subtle

Or changing
 His parcel gilt to massy gold. You cannot
 But raise you friends. Withal, to be of power
 To pay an army in the field, to buy
 The King of France out of his realms, or Spain
 Out of his Indies. What can you not do

	Against lords spiritual or temporal, That shall oppone you?
Tribulation	Verily, 'tis true.
Wholesome	We may be temporal lords ourselves, I take it. You may be anything, and leave off to make Long-winded exercises; or suck up Your "ha!" and "hum!" in a tune. I not deny, But such as are not graced in a state, May, for their ends, be adverse in religion, And get a tune to call the flock together: For, to say sooth, a tune does much with women, And other phlegmatic people; it is your bell.
Subtle	
Ananias	Bells are profane; a tune may be religious.
Subtle	No warning with you! Then farewell my patience. 'Slight, it shall down: I will not be thus tortured.
Tribulation	
Wholesome	I pray you, sir.
Subtle	All shall perish. I have spoken it. Let me find grace, sir, in your eyes; the man He stands corrected: neither did his zeal, But as yourself, allow a tune somewhere. Which now, being toward the stone, we shall not need. No, nor your holy vizard, to win widows To give you legacies; or make zealous wives To rob their husbands for the common cause: Nor take the start of bonds broke but one day, And say, they were forfeited by providence. Nor shall you need o'er night to eat huge meals, To celebrate your next day's fast the better; The whilst the Brethren and the Sisters humbled, Abate the stiffness of the flesh. Nor cast Before your hungry hearers scrupulous bones; As whether a Christian may hawk or hunt, Or whether matrons of the holy assembly May lay their hair out, or wear doublets, Or have that idol starch about their linen.
Tribulation	
Wholesome	
Subtle	

Ananias	It is indeed an idol.
Tribulation	Mind him not, sir.
Wholesome	I do command thee, spirit of zeal, but trouble, To peace within him! Pray you, sir, go on. Nor shall you need to libel 'gainst the prelates, And shorten so your ears against the hearing Of the next wire-drawn grace. Nor of necessity Rail against plays, to please the alderman Whose daily custard you devour; nor lie With zealous rage till you are hoarse. Not one Of these so singular arts. Nor call yourselves By names of Tribulation, Persecution, Restraint, Long-patience, and suchlike, affected By the whole family or wood of you, Only for glory, and to catch the ear Of the disciple.
Subtle	Truly, sir, they are Ways that the godly Brethren have invented, For propagation of the glorious cause, As very notable means, and whereby also Themselves grow soon, and profitably, famous. O, but the stone, all's idle to it! Nothing! The art of angels' nature's miracle,
Tribulation	The divine secret that doth fly in clouds
Wholesome	From east to west: and whose tradition Is not from men, but spirits.
Subtle	I hate traditions; I do not trust them—
Ananias	Peace!
Tribulation	They are popish all.
Wholesome	I will not peace: I will not—
Ananias	Ananias!
Tribulation	Please the profane, to grieve the godly; I may not.
Wholesome	
Ananias	

Subtle	Well, Ananias, thou shalt overcome.
Tribulation	It is an ignorant zeal that haunts him, sir;
Wholesome	But truly, else, a very faithful Brother, A botcher, and a man, by revelation, That hath a competent knowledge of the truth. Has he a competent sum there in the bag To buy the goods within? I am made guardian, And must, for charity, and conscience sake, Now see the most be made for my poor orphan; Though I desire the Brethren too good gainers: There they are within. When you have viewed and bought 'em, And ta'en the inventory of what they are, They are ready for projection; there's no more To do: cast on the medicine, so much silver As there is tin there, so much gold as brass, I'll give't you in by weight.
Tribulation	But how long time,
Wholesome	Sir, must the saints expect yet? Let me see, How's the moon now? Eight, nine, ten days hence, He will be silver potate; then three days Before he citronise: Some fifteen days, The <i>magisterium</i> will be perfected.
Ananias	About the second day of the third week, In the ninth month?
Subtle	Yes, my good Ananias.
Tribulation	What will the orphan's goods arise to, think you?
Wholesome	Some hundred marks, as much as filled three cars, Unladed now: you'll make six millions of them.— But I must have more coals laid in.
Subtle	
Tribulation	How?
Wholesome	
Subtle	Another load,

And then we have finished. We must now increase
Our fire to *ignis ardens*; we are past
Fimus equinus, balnei, cineris,
And all those lenter heats. If the holy purse
Should with this draught fall low, and that the saints
Do need a present sum, I have a trick
To melt the pewter, you shall buy now, instantly,
And with a tincture make you as good Dutch dollars
As any are in Holland.

Tribulation
Wholesome

Can you so?

Subtle

Ay, and shall 'bide the third examination.

Ananias

It will be joyful tidings to the Brethren.

Subtle

But you must carry it secret.

Tribulation
Wholesome

Ay; but stay,
This act of coining, is it lawful?

Lawful!

Ananias

We know no magistrate; or, if we did,
This is foreign coin.

Subtle

It is no coining, sir.
It is but casting.

Tribulation
Wholesome

Ha! You distinguish well:
Casting of money may be lawful.

Ananias

'Tis, sir.

Tribulation
Wholesome

Truly, I take it so.

Subtle

There is no scruple,
Sir, to be made of it; believe Ananias:
This case of conscience he is studied in.

Tribulation
Wholesome

I'll make a question of it to the Brethren.

Ananias

The Brethren shall approve it lawful, doubt not.
Where shall it be done?

Knocking without.

Subtle For that we'll talk anon.
 There's some to speak with me. Go in, I pray you,
 And view the parcels. That's the inventory.
 I'll come to you straight.
 Exeunt TRIBULATION and ANANIAS.
 Who is it? —Face! Appear.
 Enter FACE in his uniform.
 How now! Good prize?

Face Good pox! Yond' costive cheater
 Never came on.

Subtle How then?

Face I have walked the round
 Till now, and no such thing.

Subtle And have you quit him?

 Quit him! An hell would quit him too, he were happy.

Face 'Slight! Would you have me stalk like a mill-jade,
 All day, for one that will not yield us grains?
 I know him of old.

Subtle O, but to have gulled him,
 Had been a mastery.

Face Let him go, black boy!
 And turn thee, that some fresh news may possess thee.
 A noble count, a don of Spain, my dear
 Delicious compeer, and my party-bawd,
 Who is come hither private for his conscience,
 And brought munition with him, six great slops,
 Bigger than three Dutch hoys, beside round trunks,
 Furnished with pistolets, and pieces of eight,
 Will straight be here, my rogue, to have thy bath,
 (That is the colour,) and to make his battery
 Upon our Dol, our castle, our Cinque-Port,
 Our Dover pier, our what thou wilt. Where is she?
 She must prepare perfumes, delicate linen,
 The bath in chief, a banquet, and her wit,

	For she must milk his epididimis. Where is the doxy? I'll send her to thee:
Subtle	And but despatch my brace of little John Leydens, And come again myself.
Face	Are they within then?
Subtle	Numbering the sum.
Face	How much?
Subtle	A hundred marks, boy. <i>Exit.</i>
	Why, this is a lucky day. Ten pounds of Mammon! Three of my clerk! A portague of my grocer! This of the Brethren! Beside reversions, And states to come in the widow, and my count! My share today will not be bought for forty — <i>Enter DOL.</i>
Dol Common	What?
Face	Pounds, dainty Dorothy! Art thou so near?
Dol Common	Yes; say, lord General, how fares our camp? As with the few that had entrenched themselves Safe, by their discipline, against a world, Dol, And laughed within those trenches, and grew fat With thinking on the booties, Dol, brought in Daily by their small parties. This dear hour, A doughty don is taken with my Dol; And thou mayst make his ransom what thou wilt, My Dousabel; he shall be brought here fettered With thy fair looks, before he sees thee; and thrown In a down-bed, as dark as any dungeon; Where thou shalt keep him waking with thy drum; Thy drum, my Dol, thy drum; till he be tame As the poor blackbirds were in the great frost, Or bees are with a bason; and so hive him In the swanskin coverlid, and cambric sheets, Till he work honey and wax, my little God's-gift.
Face	

Dol Common	What is he, General?
Face	An adalantado, A grandee, girl. Was not my Dapper here yet?
Dol Common	No.
Face	Nor my Drugger?
Dol Common	Neither.
Face	A pox on 'em, They are so long a furnishing! Such stinkards Would not be seen upon these festival days.— <i>Re-enter SUBTLE.</i> How now! Have you done?
Subtle	Done. They are gone: the sum Is here in bank, my Face. I would we knew Another chapman now would buy 'em outright.
Face	'Slid, Nab shall do't against he have the widow, To furnish household.
Subtle	Excellent, well thought on: Pray God he come!
Face	I pray he keep away Till our new business be o'erpast.
Subtle	But, Face, How cam'st thou by this secret don?
Face	A spirit Brought me th' intelligence in a paper here, As I was conjuring yonder in my circle For Surly; I have my flies abroad. Your bath Is famous, Subtle, by my means. Sweet Dol, You must go tune your virginal, no losing O' the least time: and, do you hear? Good action. Firk, like a flounder; kiss, like a scallop, close; And tickle him with thy mother tongue. His great Verdugoship has not a jot of language; So much the easier to be cozened, my Dolly. He will come here in a hired coach, obscure, And our own coachman, whom I have sent as guide,

	No creature else. <i>Knocking without.</i> Who's that? <i>Exit DOL.</i>
Subtle	It is not he?
Face	O no, not yet this hour. <i>Re-enter DOL.</i>
Subtle	Who is't?
Dol Common	Dapper, Your clerk.
Face	God's will then, Queen of Fairy, On with your tire; and, Doctor, with your robes. <i>Exit DOL.</i>
	Let's dispatch him for God's sake.
Subtle	'Twill be long. I warrant you, take but the cues I give you, It shall be brief enough.
Face	<i>Goes to the window.</i> 'Slight, here are more! Abel, and I think the angry boy, the heir, That fain would quarrel.
Subtle	And the widow?
Face	No, Not that I see. Away! <i>Exit SUBTLE.</i> <i>Enter DAPPER.</i>
	O sir, you are welcome. The Doctor is within a moving for you; I have had the most ado to win him to it! — He swears you'll be the darling of the dice: He never heard her Highness dote till now. Your aunt has given you the most gracious words That can be thought on.
Dapper	Shall I see her Grace?

Face	See her, and kiss her too.— <i>Enter DRUGGER, followed by KASTRIL.</i> What, honest Nab! Hast brought the damask?
Drugger	No, sir; here's tobacco.
Face	'Tis well done, Nab; thou'lt bring the damask too?
Drugger	Yes: here's the gentleman, Captain, master Kastril, I have brought to see the Doctor.
Face	Where's the widow?
Drugger	Sir, as he likes, his sister, he says, shall come.
Face	O, is it so? Good time. Is your name Kastril, sir?
Kastril	Ay, and the best of the Kastrils, I'd be sorry else, By fifteen hundred a year. Where is the Doctor? My mad tobacco-boy, here, tells me of one That can do things: has he any skill?
Face	Wherein, sir?
Kastril	To carry a business, manage a quarrel fairly, Upon fit terms.
Face	It seems, sir, you are but young About the town, that can make that a question.
Kastril	Sir, not so young, but I have heard some speech Of the angry boys, and seen them take tobacco; And in his shop; and I can take it too. And I would fain be one of 'em, and go down And practise in the country.
Face	Sir, for the duello, The Doctor, I assure you, shall inform you, To the least shadow of a hair; and show you An instrument he has of his own making, Wherewith no sooner shall you make report Of any quarrel, but he will take the height on't Most instantly, and tell in what degree Of safety it lies in, or mortality. And how it may be borne, whether in a right line, Or a half circle; or may else be cast

Into an angle blunt, if not acute:
And this he will demonstrate. And then, rules
To give and take the lie by.

Kastril How! To take it?

Face Yes, in oblique he'll show you, or in circle;
But never in diameter. The whole town
Study his theorems, and dispute them ordinarily
At the eating academies.

Kastril But does he teach
Living by the wits too?

Face Anything whatever.
You cannot think that subtlety, but he reads it.
He made me a Captain. I was a stark pimp,
Just of your standing, 'fore I met with him;
It is not two months since. I'll tell you his method:
First, he will enter you at some ordinary.

Kastril No, I'll not come there: you shall pardon me.

Face For why, sir?

Kastril There's gaming there, and tricks.

Face Why, would you be
A gallant, and not game?

Kastril Ay, 'twill spend a man.

Face Spend you! It will repair you when you are spent:
How do they live by their wits there, that have vented
Six times your fortunes?

Kastril What, three thousand a-year!

Face Ay, forty thousand.

Kastril Are there such?

Face Ay, sir,
And gallants yet. Here's a young gentleman
Points to DAPPER.

Is born to nothing—forty marks a year,
Which I count nothing:—he is to be initiated,
And have a fly of the Doctor. He will win you,
By irresistible luck, within this fortnight,

Enough to buy a barony. They will set him
Upmost, at the Groom porter's, all the Christmas:
And for the whole year through, at every place,
Where there is play, present him with the chair;
The best attendance, the best drink; sometimes
Two glasses of Canary, and pay nothing;
The purest linen, and the sharpest knife,
The partridge next his trencher: and somewhere
The dainty bed, in private, with the dainty.
You shall have your ordinaries bid for him,
As playhouses for a poet; and the master
Pray him aloud to name what dish he affects,
Which must be buttered shrimps: and those that drink
To no mouth else, will drink to his, as being
The goodly president mouth of all the board.

Kastril

Do you not gull one?

'Ods my life! Do you think it?

You shall have a cast commander, (can but get
In credit with a glover, or a spurrier,

Face

For some two pair of either's ware aforehand,) Will, by most swift posts, dealing with him,
Arrive at competent means to keep himself,
His punk and naked boy, in excellent fashion,
And be admired for't.

Kastril

Will the Doctor teach this?

Face

He will do more, sir: when your land is gone,
As men of spirit hate to keep earth long,
In a vacation, when small money is stirring,
And ordinaries suspended till the term,
He'll show a perspective, where on one side
You shall behold the faces and the persons
Of all sufficient young heirs in town,
Whose bonds are current for commodity;
On th' other side, the merchants' forms, and others,
That without help of any second broker,
Who would expect a share, will trust such parcels:

In the third square, the very street and sign
Where the commodity dwells, and does but wait
To be delivered, be it pepper, soap,
Hops, or tobacco, oatmeal, woad, or cheeses.
All which you may so handle, to enjoy
To your own use, and never stand obliged.

Kastril I'faith! Is he such a fellow?

Why, Nab here knows him.

Face And then for making matches for rich widows,
Young gentlewomen, heirs, the fortunat'st man!
He's sent to, far and near, all over England,
To have his counsel, and to know their fortunes.

Kastril God's will, my sister shall see him.

I'll tell you, sir,

What he did tell me of Nab. It's a strange thing:—
By the way, you must eat no cheese, Nab, it breeds
melancholy,

Face And that same melancholy breeds worms; but pass
it:—

He told me, honest Nab here was ne'er at tavern
But once in's life!

Drugger Truth, and no more I was not.

Face And then he was so sick—

Drugger Could he tell you that too?

Face How should I know it?

In troth we had been a-shooting,

Drugger And had a piece of fat ram-mutton to supper,
That lay so heavy o' my stomach—

And he has no head

Face To bear any wine; for what with the noise of the fid-
dlers,

And care of his shop, for he dares keep no servants—

Drugger My head did so ache—

Face And he was fain to be brought home,
The Doctor told me: and then a good old woman—

Drugger Yes, faith, she dwells in Sea-coal Lane — did cure me,
 With sodden ale, and pellitory of the wall;
 Cost me but twopence. I had another sickness
 Was worse than that.
 Ay, that was with the grief
 Face Thou took'st for being 'sessed at eighteen-pence,
 For the water-work.
 Drugger In truth, and it was like
 T' have cost me almost my life.
 Face Thy hair went off?
 Drugger Yes, sir; 'twas done for spite.
 Face Nay, so says the Doctor.
 Pray thee, tobacco-boy, go fetch my sister;
 Kastril I'll see this learned boy before I go;
 And so shall she.
 Sir, he is busy now:
 Face But if you have a sister to fetch hither,
 Perhaps your own pains may command her sooner;
 And he by that time will be free.
 Kastril I go.
 Exit.
 Face Drugger, she's thine: the damask! —
 Exit DRUGGER.
 Subtle and I
 Must wrestle for her.
 Aside.
 —Come on, master Dapper,
 You see how I turn clients here away,
 To give your cause dispatch; have you performed
 The ceremonies were enjoined you?
 Dapper Yes, of the vinegar,
 And the clean shirt.
 Face 'Tis well: that shirt may do you
 More worship than you think. Your aunt's afire,

	But that she will not show it, t' have a sight of you. Have you provided for her Grace's servants?
Dapper	Yes, here are six score Edward shillings.
Face	Good!
Dapper	And an old Harry's sovereign.
Face	Very good!
Dapper	And three James shillings, and an Elizabeth groat, Just twenty nobles.
Face	O, you are too just. I would you had had the other noble in Marys.
Dapper	I have some Philip and Marys.
Face	Ay, those same Are best of all: where are they? Hark, the Doctor. <i>Enter SUBTLE, disguised like a priest of Fairy, with a stripe of cloth.</i>
Subtle	<i>In a feigned voice.</i> Is yet her grace's cousin come?
Face	He is come.
Subtle	And is he fasting?
Face	Yes.
Subtle	And hath cried <i>hum</i> ?
Face	Thrice, you must answer.
Dapper	Thrice.
Subtle	And as oft <i>buz</i> ?
Face	If you have, say.
Dapper	I have.
Subtle	Then, to her cuz, Hoping that he hath vinegared his senses, As he was bid, the Fairy Queen dispenses, By me, this robe, the petticoat of fortune; Which that he straight put on, she doth importune. And though to fortune near be her petticoat, Yet nearer is her smock, the Queen doth note: And therefore, ev'n of that a piece she hath sent Which, being a child, to wrap him in was rent;

And prays him for a scarf he now will wear it,
With as much love as then her Grace did tear it,
About his eyes, to show he is fortunate.
They blind him with the rag.
And, trusting unto her to make his state,
He'll throw away all worldly pelf about him;
Which that he will perform, she doth not doubt him.
She need not doubt him, sir. Alas, he has nothing,
But what he will part withal as willingly,
Upon her Grace's word—throw away your purse—
As she would ask it;—handkerchiefs and all—
He throws away, as they bid him.

Face

She cannot bid that thing, but he'll obey.—
If you have a ring about you, cast it off,
Or a silver seal at your wrist; her Grace will send
Her fairies here to search you, therefore deal
Directly with her highness: if they find
That you conceal a mite, you are undone.

Dapper

Truly, there's all.

Face

All what?

Dapper

My money; truly.
Keep nothing that is transitory about you.
Aside to SUBTLE.

Face

Bid Dol play music.—
DOL plays on the cittern within.
Look, the elves are come.
To pinch you, if you tell not truth. Advise you.
They pinch him.

Dapper

O! I have a paper with a spur-rial in't.

Face

Ti, ti.
They knew't, they say.

Subtle

Ti, ti, ti, ti. He has more yet.
Ti, ti-ti-ti.

Face

Aside to SUBTLE.
In the other pocket.

Subtle Titi, titi, titi, titi, titi.
They must pinch him or he will never confess, they
say.
They pinch him again.

Dapper O, O!
Nay, pray you, hold: he is her Grace's nephew,
Face Ti, ti, ti? What care you? Good faith, you shall care.—
Deal plainly, sir, and shame the fairies. Show
You are innocent.

Dapper By this good light, I have nothing.
Ti, ti, ti, ti, to, ta. He does equivocate she says:
Subtle Ti, ti do ti, ti ti do, ti da;
and swears by the *Light* when he is blinded.

Dapper By this good *Dark*, I have nothing but a half-crown
Of gold about my wrist, that my love gave me;
And a leaden heart I wore since she forsook me.
I thought 'twas something. And would you incur
Your aunt's displeasure for these trifles? Come,
Face I had rather you had thrown away twenty half-crowns.
Takes it off.
You may wear your leaden heart still.—
Enter DOL hastily.
How now!

Subtle What news, Dol?
Dol Common Yonder's your knight, Sir Mammon.
Face 'Ods lid, we never thought of him till now!
Where is he?

Dol Common Here hard by: he is at the door.
Subtle And you are not ready now! Dol, get his suit.
Exit DOL.
He must not be sent back.
O, by no means.

Face What shall we do with this same puffin here,
Now he's on the spit?

Subtle Why, lay him back awhile,
 With some device.
Re-enter DOL, with FACE's clothes.
 —Ti, ti, ti, ti, ti, ti, Would her Grace speak with me?
 I come.—Help, Dol!
Knocking without.
Speaks through the keyhole.
 Who's there? Sir Epicure,

Face My master's in the way. Please you to walk
 Three or four turns, but till his back be turned,
 And I am for you.—Quickly, Dol!

Subtle Her Grace
 Commends her kindly to you, master Dapper.

Dapper I long to see her Grace.
 She now is set
 At dinner in her bed, and she has sent you
 From her own private trencher, a dead mouse,

Subtle And a piece of gingerbread, to be merry withal,
 And stay your stomach, lest you faint with fasting:
 Yet if you could hold out till she saw you, she says,
 It would be better for you.
 Sir, he shall

Face Hold out, an 'twere this two hours, for her highness;
 I can assure you that. We will not lose
 All we have done.—

Subtle He must not see, nor speak
 To anybody, till then.

Face For that we'll put, sir,
 A stay in's mouth.

Subtle Of what?
 Of gingerbread.

Face Make you it fit. He that hath pleased her Grace
 Thus far, shall not now crinkle for a little.—
 Gape, sir, and let him fit you.
They thrust a gag of gingerbread in his mouth.

Subtle	Where shall we now Bestow him?
Dol Common	In the privy.
Subtle	Come along, sir, I now must show you Fortune's privy lodgings.
Face	Are they perfumed, and his bath ready?
Subtle	All: Only the fumigation's somewhat strong.
Face	<i>Speaking through the keyhole.</i> Sir Epicure, I am yours, sir, by and by. <i>Exeunt with DAPPER.</i>

ACT IV

SCENE I

A room in LOVEWIT'S house.

Enter FACE and MAMMON.

Face

O sir, you're come in the only finest time.—

Sir Epicure

Where's master?

Mammon

Face

Now preparing for projection, sir.

Your stuff will be all changed shortly.

Sir Epicure

Into gold?

Mammon

Face

To gold and silver, sir.

Sir Epicure

Silver I care not for.

Mammon

Face

Yes, sir, a little to give beggars.

Sir Epicure

Where's the lady?

Mammon

Face

At hand here. I have told her such brave things of you,
Touching your bounty, and your noble spirit—

Sir Epicure

Hast thou?

Mammon

Face

As she is almost in her fit to see you.

But, good sir, no divinity in your conference,
For fear of putting her in rage.—

Sir Epicure
Mammon

I warrant thee.

Face

Six men [sir] will not hold her down: and then,
If the old man should hear or see you—

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Fear not.

Face

The very house, sir, would run mad. You know it,
How scrupulous he is, and violent,
'Gainst the least act of sin. Physic, or mathematics,
Poetry, state, or bawdry, as I told you,
She will endure, and never startle; but
No word of controversy.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

I am schooled, good Ulen.

Face

And you must praise her house, remember that,
And her nobility.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Let me alone:
No herald, no, nor antiquary, Lungs,
Shall do it better. Go.

Face

Aside. Why, this is yet
A kind of modern happiness, to have
Dol Common for a great lady.

Exit.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Now, Epicure,
Heighten thyself, talk to her all in gold;
Rain her as many showers as Jove did drops
Unto his Danae; show the god a miser,
Compared with Mammon. What! The stone will do't.
She shall feel gold, taste gold, hear gold, sleep gold;
Nay, we will *concumbere* gold: I will be puissant,
And mighty in my talk to her.—

Re-enter FACE, with DOL richly dressed.

Here she comes.

Face	To him, Dol, suckle him.— This is the noble knight, I told your ladyship—
Sir Epicure Mammon	Madam, with your pardon, I kiss your vesture.
Dol Common	Sir, I were uncivil If I would suffer that; my lip to you, sir.
Sir Epicure Mammon	I hope my lord your brother be in health, lady.
Dol Common	My lord, my brother is, though I no lady, sir.
Face	<i>Aside.</i> Well said, my Guinea bird.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Right noble madam—
Face	<i>Aside.</i> O, we shall have most fierce idolatry.
Sir Epicure Mammon	'Tis your prerogative.
Dol Common	Rather your courtesy.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Were there nought else to enlarge your virtues to me, These answers speak your breeding and your blood.
Dol Common	Blood we boast none, sir, a poor baron's daughter. Poor! And gat you? Profane not. Had your father Slept all the happy remnant of his life After that act, lien but there still, and panted, He had done enough to make himself, his issue, And his posterity noble.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Sir, although
Dol Common	We may be said to want the gilt and trappings, The dress of honour, yet we strive to keep The seeds and the materials.
Sir Epicure Mammon	I do see The old ingredient, virtue, was not lost, Nor the drug money used to make your compound. There is a strange nobility in your eye, This lip, that chin! Methinks you do resemble One of the Austriac princes.

Face	Very like!
	<i>Aside.</i>
	Her father was an Irish costermonger.
Sir Epicure	The house of Valois just had such a nose,
Mammon	And such a forehead yet the Medici
	Of Florence boast.
Dol Common	Troth, and I have been likened
	To all these princes.
Face	<i>Aside.</i> I'll be sworn, I heard it.
Sir Epicure	I know not how! It is not anyone,
Mammon	But e'en the very choice of all their features.
Face	<i>Aside.</i> I'll in, and laugh.
	<i>Exit.</i>
Sir Epicure	A certain touch, or air,
Mammon	That sparkles a divinity, beyond
	An earthly beauty!
Dol Common	O, you play the courtier.
Sir Epicure	Good lady, give me leave—
Mammon	
Dol Common	In faith, I may not,
	To mock me, sir.
Sir Epicure	To burn in this sweet flame;
Mammon	The phoenix never knew a nobler death.
	Nay, now you court the courtier, and destroy
Dol Common	What you would build. This art, sir, in your words,
	Calls your whole faith in question.
Sir Epicure	By my soul—
Mammon	
Dol Common	Nay, oaths are made of the same air, sir.
	Nature
Sir Epicure	Never bestowed upon mortality
Mammon	A more unblamed, a more harmonious feature;
	She played the stepdame in all faces else:
	Sweet Madam, let me be particular—

Dol Common	Particular, sir! I pray you know your distance.
Sir Epicure Mammon	In no ill sense, sweet lady; but to ask How your fair graces pass the hours? I see You are lodged here, in the house of a rare man, An excellent artist; but what's that to you?
Dol Common	Yes, sir; I study here the mathematics, And distillation. O, I cry your pardon. He's a divine instructor! Can extract The souls of all things by his art; call all The virtues, and the miracles of the sun, Into a temperate furnace; teach dull nature What her own forces are. A man, the emperor Has courted above Kelly; sent his medals And chains, to invite him.
Dol Common	Ay, and for his physic, sir—
Sir Epicure Mammon	Above the art of Aesculapius, That drew the envy of the thunderer! I know all this, and more.
Dol Common	Troth, I am taken, sir, Whole with these studies, that contemplate nature. It is a noble humour; but this form Was not intended to so dark a use. Had you been crooked, foul, of some coarse mould A cloister had done well; but such a feature That might stand up the glory of a kingdom, To live recluse! Is a mere soloecism, Though in a nunnery. It must not be. I muse, my lord your brother will permit it: You should spend half my land first, were I he. Does not this diamond better on my finger, Than in the quarry?
Dol Common	Yes.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Why, you are like it. You were created, lady, for the light.

	Here, you shall wear it; take it, the first pledge Of what I speak, to bind you to believe me.
Dol Common	In chains of adamant?
Sir Epicure	Yes, the strongest bands.
Mammon	And take a secret too—here, by your side, Doth stand this hour, the happiest man in Europe.
Dol Common	You are contended, sir!
Sir Epicure	Nay, in true being,
Mammon	The envy of princes and the fear of states.
Dol Common	Say you so, Sir Epicure?
	Yes, and thou shalt prove it,
Sir Epicure	Daughter of honour. I have cast mine eye
Mammon	Upon thy form, and I will rear this beauty Above all styles.
Dol Common	You mean no treason, sir?
Sir Epicure	No, I will take away that jealousy.
Mammon	I am the lord of the philosopher's stone, And thou the lady.
Dol Common	How, sir! Have you that?
	I am the master of the mystery.
	This day the good old wretch here o' the house Has made it for us: now he's at projection.
Sir Epicure	Think therefore thy first wish now, let me hear it;
Mammon	And it shall rain into thy lap, no shower, But floods of gold, whole cataracts, a deluge, To get a nation on thee.
Dol Common	You are pleased, sir, To work on the ambition of our sex.
Sir Epicure	I am pleased the glory of her sex should know,
Mammon	This nook, here, of the Friars is no climate For her to live obscurely in, to learn Physic and surgery, for the constable's wife Of some odd hundred in Essex; but come forth, And taste the air of palaces; eat, drink The toils of empirics, and their boasted practice;

Tincture of pearl, and coral, gold, and amber;
Be seen at feasts and triumphs; have it asked,
What miracle she is; set all the eyes
Of court afire, like a burning glass,
And work them into cinders, when the jewels
Of twenty states adorn thee, and the light
Strikes out the stars! That when thy name is men-
tioned,
Queens may look pale; and we but showing our love,
Nero's Poppaea may be lost in story!
Thus will we have it.

I could well consent, sir.
But, in a monarchy, how will this be?
Dol Common The prince will soon take notice, and both seize
You and your stone, it being a wealth unfit
For any private subject.

Sir Epicure
Mammon If he knew it.

Dol Common Yourself do boast it, sir.

Sir Epicure
Mammon To thee, my life.

O, but beware, sir! You may come to end
Dol Common The remnants of your days in a loathed prison,
By speaking of it.

'Tis no idle fear.
Sir Epicure
Mammon We'll therefore go withal, my girl, and live
In a free state, where we will eat our mullets,
Soused in high-country wines, sup pheasants' eggs,
And have our cockles boiled in silver shells;
Our shrimps to swim again, as when they lived,
In a rare butter made of dolphins' milk,
Whose cream does look like opals; and with these
Delicate meats set ourselves high for pleasure,
And take us down again, and then renew
Our youth and strength with drinking the elixir,
And so enjoy a perpetuity

Of life and lust! And thou shalt have thy wardrobe
Richer than nature's, still to change thyself,
And vary oftener, for thy pride, than she,
Or art, her wise and almost-equal servant.

Re-enter FACE.

Face Sir, you are too loud. I hear you every word
Into the laboratory. Some fitter place;
The garden, or great chamber above. How like you
her?

Sir Epicure
Mammon Excellent! Lungs. There's for thee.

Gives him money.

Face But do you hear?
Good sir, beware, no mention of the Rabbins.

Sir Epicure
Mammon We think not on 'em.

Exeunt MAMMON and DOL.

Face O, it is well, sir.—Subtle!
Enter SUBTLE.

Dost thou not laugh?

Subtle Yes; are they gone?

Face All's clear.

Subtle The widow is come.

Face And your quarrelling disciple?

Subtle Ay.

Face I must to my captainship again then.

Subtle Stay, bring them in first.

Face So I meant. What is she?
A bonnibel?

Subtle I know not.

Face We'll draw lots:
You'll stand to that?

Subtle What else?

Face	O, for a suit, To fall now like a curtain, flap!
Subtle	To the door, man.
Face	You'll have the first kiss, 'cause I am not ready. <i>Exit.</i>
Subtle	Yes, and perhaps hit you through both the nostrils.
Face	<i>Within.</i> Who would you speak with?
Kastril	<i>Within.</i> Where's the Captain?
Face	<i>Within.</i> Gone, sir, About some business.
Kastril	<i>Within.</i> Gone!
Face	<i>Within.</i> He'll return straight. But Master Doctor, his lieutenant, is here. <i>Enter KASTRIL, followed by DAME PLIANT.</i> Come near, my worshipful boy, my <i>terrae fili</i> , That is, my boy of land; make thy approaches: Welcome; I know thy lusts, and thy desires, And I will serve and satisfy them. Begin, Charge me from thence, or thence, or in this line; Here is my centre: ground thy quarrel.
Subtle	
Kastril	You lie.
Subtle	How, child of wrath and anger! The loud lie? For what, my sudden boy?
Kastril	Nay, that look you to, I am aforehand. O, this is no true grammar, And as ill logic! You must render causes, child, Your first and second intentions, know your canons And your divisions, moods, degrees, and differences, Your predicaments, substance, and accident, Series, extern and intern, with their causes, Efficient, material, formal, final, And have your elements perfect.
Subtle	
Kastril	<i>Aside.</i> What is this?

The angry tongue he talks in?
 That false precept,
 Of being aforehand, has deceived a number,
 Subtle And made them enter quarrels, oftentimes,
 Before they were aware; and afterward,
 Against their wills.
 Kastril How must I do then, sir?
 I cry this lady mercy: she should first
 Have been saluted.
 Subtle *Kisses her.*
 I do call you lady,
 Because you are to be one, ere't be long,
 My soft and buxom widow.
 Kastril Is she, i'faith?
 Subtle Yes, or my art is an egregious liar.
 Kastril How know you?
 By inspection on her forehead,
 And subtlety of her lip, which must be tasted
 Often to make a judgment.
 Subtle *Kisses her again.*
 'Slight, she melts
 Like a myrobolane: — here is yet a line,
 In *rivo frontis*, tells me he is no knight.
 Dame Pliant What is he then, sir?
 Let me see your hand.
 O, your *linea fortunae makes it plain*;
 Subtle And stella here in *monte Veneris*.
 But, most of all, *junctura annularis*.
 He is a soldier, or a man of art, lady,
 But shall have some great honour shortly.
 Dame Pliant Brother,
 He's a rare man, believe me!
Re-enter FACE, in his uniform.
 Kastril Hold your peace.
 Here comes the t'other rare man. — 'Save you, Cap-

tain.

Face Good master Kastril! Is this your sister?

Kastril Ay, sir.
Please you to kiss her, and be proud to know her.

Face I shall be proud to know you, lady.

Kisses her.

Dame Pliant Brother,
He calls me lady too.

Kastril Ay, peace: I heard it.
Takes her aside.

Face The count is come.

Subtle Where is he?

Face At the door.

Subtle Why, you must entertain him.

Face What will you do
With these the while?

Subtle Why, have them up, and show them
Some fustian book, or the dark glass.

Face 'Fore God,
She is a delicate dabchick! I must have her.

Exit.

Subtle Must you! Ay, if your fortune will, you must.—
Come, sir, the Captain will come to us presently:
I'll have you to my chamber of demonstrations,
Where I will show you both the grammar and logic,
And rhetoric of quarrelling; my whole method
Drawn out in tables; and my instrument,
That hath the several scales upon't, shall make you
Able to quarrel at a straw's-breadth by moonlight.
And, lady, I'll have you look in a glass,
Some half an hour, but to clear your eyesight,
Against you see your fortune; which is greater,
Than I may judge upon the sudden, trust me.

Exit, followed by KASTRIL and DAME PLIANT.

Re-enter FACE.

Face Where are you, Doctor?

Subtle *Within.* I'll come to you presently.

Face I will have this same widow, now I have seen her,
On any composition.

Re-enter SUBTLE.

Subtle What do you say?

Face Have you disposed of them?

Subtle I have sent them up.

Face Subtle, in troth, I needs must have this widow.

Subtle Is that the matter?

Face Nay, but hear me.

Go to.

Subtle If you rebel once, Dol shall know it all:
Therefore be quiet, and obey your chance.

Face Nay, thou art so violent now — Do but conceive,
Thou art old, and canst not serve —

Subtle Who cannot? I?
'Slight, I will serve her with thee, for a —

Face Nay,
But understand: I'll give you composition.
I will not treat with thee; what! Sell my fortune?
Subtle 'Tis better than my birthright. Do not murmur:
Win her, and carry her. If you grumble, Dol
Knows it directly.

Face Well, sir, I am silent.
Will you go help to fetch in Don in state?

Exit.

Subtle I follow you, sir. We must keep Face in awe,
Or he will overlook us like a tyrant.

Re-enter FACE, introducing SURLY disguised as a Spaniard.

Brain of a tailor! Who comes here? Don John!

Pertinax Surly	<i>Señores, beso las manos a vuestras mercedes.</i>
Subtle	Would you had stooped a little, and kissed our <i>anos</i> !
Face	Peace, Subtle.
	Stab me; I shall never hold, man.
Subtle	He looks in that deep ruff like a head in a platter, Served in by a short cloak upon two trestles.
Face	Or, what do you say to a collar of brawn, cut down Beneath the souse, and wriggled with a knife?
Subtle	'Slud, he does look too fat to be a Spaniard.
Face	Perhaps some Fleming or some Hollander got him In d'Alva's time; Count Egmont's bastard.
Subtle	Don, Your scurvy, yellow, Madrid face is welcome.
Pertinax Surly	<i>Gratia.</i>
Subtle	He speaks out of a fortification. Pray God he have no squibs in those deep sets.
Pertinax Surly	<i>Por dios, señores, muy linda casa!</i>
Subtle	What says he?
Face	Praises the house, I think; I know no more but's action.
	Yes, the <i>casa</i> ,
Subtle	My precious Diego, will prove fair enough To cozen you in. Do you mark? You shall Be cozened, Diego.
Face	Cozened, do you see, My worthy Donzel, cozened.
Pertinax Surly	<i>Entiendo.</i>
	Do you intend it? So do we, dear Don.
Subtle	Have you brought pistols, or portagues, My solemn Don?—Dost thou feel any?
Face	<i>Feels his pockets.</i> Full.
Subtle	You shall be emptied, Don, pumped and drawn Dry, as they say.
Face	Milked, in troth, sweet Don.

Subtle	See all the monsters; the great lion of all, Don.
Pertinax Surly	<i>Con licencia, se puede ver a esta señora?</i>
Subtle	What talks he now?
Face	Of the Señora.
	O, Don,
Subtle	This is the lioness, which you shall see Also, my Don.
Face	'Slid, Subtle, how shall we do?
Subtle	For what?
Face	Why Dol's employed, you know.
	That's true.
Subtle	'Fore heaven, I know not: he must stay, that's all.
Face	Stay! That he must not by no means.
Subtle	No! Why?
	Unless you'll mar all. 'Slight, he will suspect it: And then he will not pay, not half so well.
Face	This is a travelled punk-master, and does know All the delays; a notable hot rascal, And looks already rampant.
	'Sdeath, and Mammon
Subtle	Must not be troubled.
Face	Mammon! In no case.
Subtle	What shall we do then?
Face	Think: you must be sudden.
	<i>Entiendo que la señora es tan hermosa, que codicio tan</i>
Pertinax Surly	<i>verla, como la bien aventuranza de mi vida.</i>
Face	<i>Mi vida!</i> 'Slid, Subtle, he puts me in mind of the wid- ow. What dost thou say to draw her to it, ha! And tell her 'tis her fortune? All our venture Now lies upon't. It is but one man more, Which of us chance to have her: and beside,

There is no maidenhead to be feared or lost.
 What dost thou think on't, Subtle?
 Subtle Who? I? Why —
 Face The credit of our house too is engaged.
 Subtle You made me an offer for my share erewhile.
 What wilt thou give me, i' faith?
 O, by that light
 Face I'll not buy now: You know your doom to me.
 E'en take your lot, obey your chance, sir; win her,
 And wear her out, for me.
 Subtle 'Slight, I'll not work her then.
 Face It is the common cause; therefore bethink you.
 Dol else must know it, as you said.
 Subtle I care not.
 Pertinax Surly *Señores, porque se tarda tanto?*
 Subtle Faith, I am not fit, I am old.
 Face That's now no reason, sir.
 Pertinax Surly *Puede ser de hazer burla de mi amor?*
 Face You hear the Don too? By this air, I call,
 And loose the hinges: Dol!
 Subtle A plague of hell —
 Face Will you then do?
 Subtle You are a terrible rogue!
 I'll think of this: will you, sir, call the widow?
 Face Yes, and I'll take her too with all her faults,
 Now I do think on't better.
 Subtle With all my heart, sir;
 Am I discharged o' the lot?
 Face As you please.
 Subtle Hands.
They take hands.
 Face Remember now, that upon any change,
 You never claim her.

Subtle Much good joy, and health to you, sir,
 Marry a whore! Fate, let me wed a witch first.

Pertinax Surly *Por estas honradas barbas—*

Subtle He swears by his beard.
 Dispatch, and call the brother too.
 Exit FACE.

Pertinax Surly *Tengo duda, señores,*
 que no me hagan alguna traycion.
 How, issue on? Yes, *praesto, sennor*. Please you
 Enthratha the *chambrata*, worthy Don:
 Where if you please the fates, in your *bathada*,
 You shall be soaked, and stroked, and tubbed and
 rubbed,
 And scrubbed, and fubbed, dear Don, before you go.
 You shall in faith, my scurvy baboon Don,
 Be curried, clawed, and flawed, and tawed, indeed.
 I will the heartlier go about it now,
 And make the widow a punk so much the sooner,
 To be revenged on this impetuous Face:
 The quickly doing of it is the grace.
 Exeunt SUBTLE and SURLY.

SCENE II

Another room in the same.

Enter FACE, KASTRIL, and DAME PLIANT.

Face Come, lady: I knew the Doctor would not leave,
 Till he had found the very nick of her fortune.

Kastril To be a countess, say you, a Spanish countess, sir?

Dame Pliant Why, is that better than an English countess?

Face	Better! 'Slight, make you that a question, lady?
Kastril	Nay, she is a fool, Captain, you must pardon her. Ask from your courtier, to your inns-of-court-man, To your mere milliner; they will tell you all, Your Spanish jennet is the best horse; your Spanish Stoop is the best garb; your Spanish beard
Face	Is the best cut; your Spanish ruffs are the best Wear; your Spanish pavan the best dance; Your Spanish titillation in a glove The best perfume: and for your Spanish pike, And Spanish blade, let your poor Captain speak— Here comes the Doctor. <i>Enter SUBTLE, with a paper.</i>
Subtle	My most honoured lady, For so I am now to style you, having found By this my scheme, you are to undergo An honourable fortune, very shortly. What will you say now, if some— I have told her all, sir,
Face	And her right worshipful brother here, that she shall be A countess; do not delay them, sir; a Spanish countess. Still, my scarce-worshipful Captain, you can keep
Subtle	No secret! Well, since he has told you, madam, Do you forgive him, and I do.
Kastril	She shall do that, sir; I'll look to it, 'tis my charge.
Subtle	Well then: nought rests But that she fit her love now to her fortune.
Dame Pliant	Truly I shall never brook a Spaniard.
Subtle	No!
Dame Pliant	Never since eighty-eight could I abide them, And that was some three year afore I was born, in truth.
Subtle	Come, you must love him, or be miserable, Choose which you will.
Face	By this good rush, persuade her,

She will cry strawberries else within this twelvemonth.
 Subtle Nay, shads and mackerel, which is worse.
 Face Indeed, sir!
 Kastril Od's lid, you shall love him, or I'll kick you.
 Dame Pliant Why,
 I'll do as you will have me, brother.
 Kastril Do,
 Or by this hand I'll maul you.
 Face Nay, good sir,
 Be not so fierce.
 Subtle No, my enraged child;
 She will be ruled. What, when she comes to taste
 The pleasures of a countess! To be courted—
 Face And kissed, and ruffled!
 Subtle Ay, behind the hangings.
 Face And then come forth in pomp!
 Subtle And know her state!
 Face Of keeping all the idolaters of the chamber
 Barer to her, than at their prayers!
 Subtle Is served
 Upon the knee!
 Face And has her pages, ushers,
 Footmen, and coaches—
 Subtle Her six mares—
 Face Nay, eight!
 Subtle To hurry her through London, to the Exchange,
 Bedlam, the china-houses—
 Yes, and have
 Face The citizens gape at her, and praise her tires,
 And my lord's goose-turd bands, that ride with her!
 Kastril Most brave! By this hand, you are not my sister,
 If you refuse.
 Dame Pliant I will not refuse, brother.

Enter SURLY.

Pertinax Surly *Que es esto, señores, que no venga?
Esta tardanza me mata!*

Face It is the Count come:
The Doctor knew he would be here, by his art.

Subtle *En gallanta madama, Don! Gallantissima!*

Pertinax Surly *Por todos los dioses, la mas acabada
hermosura, que he visto en mi vida!*

Face Is't not a gallant language that they speak?

Kastril An admirable language! Is't not French?

Face No, Spanish, sir.

Kastril It goes like law-French,
And that, they say, is the courtliest language.

Face List, sir.

Pertinax Surly *El sol ha perdido su lumbre, con el
Esplendor que trae esta dama! Válgame Dios!*

Face He admires your sister.

Kastril Must not she make curtesy?
'Ods will, she must go to him, man, and kiss him!

Subtle It is the Spanish fashion, for the women
To make first court.

Face 'Tis true he tells you, sir:
His art knows all.

Pertinax Surly *Porqué no se acude?*

Kastril He speaks to her, I think.

Face That he does, sir.

Pertinax Surly *Por el amor de Dios, qué es esto que se tarda?*

Kastril Nay, see: she will not understand him! Gull,
Noddy.

Dame Pliant What say you, brother?

Ass, my sister.

Kastril Go kiss him, as the cunning man would have you;
I'll thrust a pin in your buttocks else.

Face O no, sir.
 Pertinax Surly *Señora mía, mi persona esta muy indigna de
Allegara tanta hermosura.*
 Face Does he not use her bravely?
 Kastril Bravely, i' faith!
 Face Nay, he will use her better.
 Kastril Do you think so?
 Pertinax Surly *Señora, si sera servida, entremonos.*
Exit with DAME PLIANT.
 Kastril Where does he carry her?
 Face Into the garden, sir;
 Take you no thought: I must interpret for her.
 Give Dol the word.
 Subtle *Aside to FACE, who goes out.*
 —Come, my fierce child, advance,
 We'll to our quarrelling lesson again.
 Kastril Agreed.
 I love a Spanish boy with all my heart.
 Subtle Nay, and by this means, sir, you shall be brother
 To a great count.
 Kastril Ay, I knew that at first,
 This match will advance the house of the Kastrils.
 Subtle 'Pray God your sister prove but pliant!
 Kastril Why,
 Her name is so, by her other husband.
 Subtle How!
 Kastril The widow Pliant. Knew you not that?
 No, faith, sir;
 Subtle Yet, by erection of her figure, I guessed it.
 Come, let's go practise.
 Kastril Yes, but do you think, Doctor,
 I e'er shall quarrel well?
 Subtle I warrant you.

Exeunt.

SCENE III

Another room in the same.

Enter DOL in her fit of raving, followed by MAMMON.

Dol Common “For after Alexander’s death” —

Sir Epicure
Mammon Good lady —

Dol Common “That Perdiccas and Antigonus, were slain,
The two that stood, Seleuc’, and Ptolomee” —

Sir Epicure
Mammon Madam —

Dol Common “Made up the two legs, and the fourth beast,
That was Gog-north, and Egypt-south: which after
Was called Gog-iron-leg and South-iron-leg” —

Sir Epicure
Mammon Lady —

Dol Common “And then Gog-horned. So was Egypt, too:
Then Egypt-clay-leg, and Gog-clay-leg” —

Sir Epicure
Mammon Sweet madam —

Dol Common “And last Gog-dust, and Egypt-dust, which fall
In the last link of the fourth chain. And these
Be stars in story, which none see, or look at” —

Sir Epicure
Mammon What shall I do?

Dol Common “For,” as he says, “except
We call the Rabbins, and the heathen Greeks” —

Sir Epicure Dear lady —

Mammon

Dol Common

“To come from Salem, and from Athens,
And teach the people of Great Britain” —
Enter FACE, hastily, in his servant’s dress.

Face

What’s the matter, sir?

Dol Common

“To speak the tongue of Eber, and Javan” —

Sir Epicure

O,

Mammon

She’s in her fit.

Dol Common

“We shall know nothing” —

Face

Death, sir,
We are undone!

Dol Common

“Where then a learned linguist
Shall see the ancient used communion
Of vowels and consonants” —

Face

My master will hear!

Dol Common

“A wisdom, which Pythagoras held most high” —

Sir Epicure

Sweet honourable lady!

Mammon

Dol Common

“To comprise
All sounds of voices, in few marks of letters” —

Face

Nay, you must never hope to lay her now.
They all speak together.

Dol Common

“And so we may arrive by Talmud skill,
And profane Greek, to raise the building up
Of Helen’s house against the Ismaelite,
King of Thogarma, and his habergions
Brimstony, blue, and fiery; and the force
Of king Abaddon, and the beast of Cittim:
Which rabbi David Kimchi, Onkelos,
And Aben Ezra do interpret Rome.”

Face

How did you put her into’t?

Sir Epicure

Alas, I talked

Mammon

Of a fifth monarchy I would erect,

	With the philosopher's stone, by chance, and she Falls on the other four straight.
Face	Out of Broughton! I told you so. 'Slid, stop her mouth.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Is't best?
Face	She'll never leave else. If the old man hear her, We are but faeces, ashes.
Subtle	<i>Within</i> . What's to do there?
Face	O, we are lost! Now she hears him, she is quiet. <i>Enter SUBTLE, they run different ways.</i>
Sir Epicure Mammon	Where shall I hide me!
	How! What sight is here?
Subtle	Close deeds of darkness, and that shun the light! Bring him again. Who is he? What, my son! O, I have lived too long.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Nay, good, dear Father, There was no unchaste purpose.
Subtle	Not? And flee me When I come in?
Sir Epicure Mammon	That was my error.
	Error?
Subtle	Guilt, guilt, my son: give it the right name. No marvel, If I found check in our great work within, When such affairs as these were managing!
Sir Epicure Mammon	Why, have you so?
	It has stood still this half hour:
Subtle	And all the rest of our less works gone back. Where is the instrument of wickedness, My lewd false drudge?
Sir Epicure	Nay, good sir, blame not him;

Mammon	Believe me, 'twas against his will or knowledge: I saw her by chance.
Subtle	Will you commit more sin, To excuse a varlet?
Sir Epicure Mammon	By my hope, 'tis true, sir.
Subtle	Nay, then I wonder less, if you, for whom The blessing was prepared, would so tempt heaven, And lose your fortunes.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Why, sir?
Subtle	This will retard The work a month at least.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Why, if it do, What remedy? But think it not, good Father: Our purposes were honest.
Subtle	As they were, So the reward will prove. <i>A loud explosion within.</i> —How now! Ah me! God, and all saints be good to us.— <i>Re-enter FACE.</i> What's that?
Face	O, sir, we are defeated! All the works Are flown <i>in fumo</i> , every glass is burst; Furnace, and all rent down, as if a bolt Of thunder had been driven through the house. Retorts, receivers, pelicans, bolt-heads, All struck in shivers! <i>SUBTLE falls down as in a swoon.</i> Help, good sir! Alas, Coldness and death invades him. Nay, Sir Mammon, Do the fair offices of a man! You stand, As you were readier to depart than he.

Knocking within.

Who's there? My lord her brother is come.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Ha, Lungs!

Face

His coach is at the door. Avoid his sight,
For he's as furious as his sister's mad.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Alas!

Face

My brain is quite undone with the fume, sir,
I ne'er must hope to be mine own man again.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Is all lost, Lungs? Will nothing be preserved
Of all our cost?

Face

Faith, very little, sir;
A peck of coals or so, which is cold comfort, sir.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

O, my voluptuous mind! I am justly punished.

Face

And so am I, sir.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Cast from all my hopes—

Face

Nay, certainties, sir.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

By mine own base affections.

Subtle

Seeming to come to himself.

O, the curst fruits of vice and lust!

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Good Father,
It was my sin. Forgive it.

Subtle

Hangs my roof
Over us still, and will not fall, O justice,
Upon us, for this wicked man!

Face

Nay, look, sir,
You grieve him now with staying in his sight:
Good sir, the nobleman will come too, and take you,
And that may breed a tragedy.

Sir Epicure

I'll go.

Mammon

Face

Ay, and repent at home, sir. It may be,
For some good penance you may have it yet;
A hundred pound to the box at Bedlam—

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Yes.

Face

For the restoring such as—have their wits.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

I'll do't.

Face

I'll send one to you to receive it.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Do.

Is no projection left?

Face

All flown, or stinks, sir.

Sir Epicure
Mammon

Will nought be saved that's good for medicine, think'st
thou?

Face

I cannot tell, sir. There will be perhaps,
Something about the scraping of the shards,
Will cure the itch—though not your itch of mind, sir.
Aside.

It shall be saved for you, and sent home. Good sir,
This way, for fear the lord should meet you.

Exit MAMMON.

Subtle

Raising his head. Face!

Face

Ay.

Subtle

Is he gone?

Face

Yes, and as heavily
As all the gold he hoped for were in's blood.
Let us be light though.

Subtle

Leaping up. Ay, as balls, and bound
And hit our heads against the roof for joy:
There's so much of our care now cast away.

Face

Now to our Don.

Subtle

Yes, your young widow by this time
Is made a countess, Face; she has been in travail

Of a young heir for you.
 Face Good sir.
 Off with your case,
 Subtle And greet her kindly, as a bridegroom should,
 After these common hazards.
 Face Very well, sir.
 Will you go fetch Don Diego off, the while?
 Subtle And fetch him over too, if you'll be pleased, sir:
 Would Dol were in her place, to pick his pockets now!
 Face Why, you can do't as well, if you would set to't.
 I pray you prove your virtue.
 Subtle For your sake sir.
 Exeunt.

SCENE IV

Another room in the same.

Enter SURLY and DAME PLIANT.

Pertinax Lady, you see into what hands you are fallen;
 Surly 'Mongst what a nest of villains! And how near
 Your honour was t' have caught a certain clap,
 Through your credulity, had I but been
 So punctually forward, as place, time,
 And other circumstances would have made a man;
 For you're a handsome woman: would you were wise too!
 I am a gentleman come here disguised,
 Only to find the knaveries of this citadel;
 And where I might have wronged your honour, and have
 not,
 I claim some interest in your love. You are,

They say, a widow, rich: and I'm a bachelor,
Worth nought: your fortunes may make me a man,
As mine have preserved you a woman. Think upon it,
And whether I have deserved you or no.

Dame Pliant I will, sir.

Pertinax And for these household-rogues, let me alone
Surly To treat with them.

Enter SUBTLE.

How doth my noble Diego,
And my dear madam Countess? Hath the Count
Been courteous, lady? Liberal, and open?
Donzel, methinks you look melancholic,
Subtle After your coitum, and scurvy: truly,
I do not like the dullness of your eye;
It hath a heavy cast, 'tis upsee Dutch,
And says you are a lumpish whoremaster.
Be lighter, and I will make your pockets so.
Attempts to pick them.

Throws open his cloak. Will you, don bawd and pickpurse?
Strikes him down.

Pertinax How now! Reel you?
Surly Stand up, sir, you shall find, since I am so heavy,
I'll give you equal weight.

Subtle Help! Murder!

No, sir,
There's no such thing intended: a good cart,
Pertinax And a clean whip shall ease you of that fear.
Surly I am the Spanish Don "that should be cozened,
Do you see, cozened?" Where's your Captain Face,
That parcel broker, and whole-bawd, all rascal!

Enter FACE, in his uniform.

Face How, Surly!

Pertinax O, make your approach, good Captain.

Surly I have found from whence your copper rings and spoons
Come, now, wherewith you cheat abroad in taverns.

'Twas here you learned t' anoint your boot with brimstone,
Then rub men's gold on't for a kind of touch,
And say 'twas naught, when you had changed the colour,
That you might have't for nothing. And this Doctor,
Your sooty, smoky-bearded compeer, he
Will close you so much gold, in a bolt's head,
And, on a turn, convey in the stead another
With sublimed mercury, that shall burst in the heat,
And fly out all *in fumo*! Then weeps Mammon;
Then swoons his worship.

FACE slips out.

Or, he is the Faustus,
That casteth figures and can conjure, cures
Plagues, piles, and pox, by the ephemerides,
And holds intelligence with all the bawds
And midwives of three shires: while you send in—
Captain!—what! Is he gone?—damsels with child,
Wives that are barren, or the waiting-maid
With the green sickness.

Seizes SUBTLE as he is retiring.

—Nay, sir, you must tarry,
Though he be 'scaped; and answer by the ears, sir.

Re-enter FACE, with KASTRIL.

Face	Why, now's the time, if ever you will quarrel Well, as they say, and be a true-born child: The Doctor and your sister both are abused.
Kastril	Where is he? Which is he? He is a slave, Whate'er he is, and the son of a whore.—Are you The man, sir, I would know?
Pertinax Surly	I should be loath, sir, To confess so much.
Kastril	Then you lie in your throat.
Pertinax Surly	How!
Face	<i>To KASTRIL.</i> A very errant rogue, sir, and a cheater,

Employed here by another conjurer
That does not love the Doctor, and would cross him,
If he knew how.

Pertinax
Surly Sir, you are abused.

Kastril You lie:
And 'tis no matter.

Face Well said, sir! He is
The impudent'st rascal—

Pertinax
Surly You are indeed: Will you hear me, sir?

Face By no means: bid him be gone.

Kastril Begone, sir, quickly.

Pertinax
Surly This 's strange!—Lady, do you inform your brother.

Face There is not such a foist in all the town,
The Doctor had him presently; and finds yet,
The Spanish Count will come here.

Aside.

—Bear up, Subtle.

Subtle Yes, sir, he must appear within this hour.

Face And yet this rogue would come in a disguise,
By the temptation of another spirit,
To trouble our art, though he could not hurt it!

Ay,

Kastril I know—

To his sister.

Away, you talk like a foolish mauther.

Pertinax
Surly Sir, all is truth she says.

Face Do not believe him, sir.
He is the lying'st swabber! Come your ways, sir.

Pertinax
Surly You are valiant out of company!

Kastril Yes, how then, sir?
Enter DRUGGER, with a piece of damask.
Nay, here's an honest fellow, too, that knows him,
And all his tricks. Make good what I say, Abel,
Aside to DRUGGER.

Face This cheater would have cozened thee o' the widow.—
He owes this honest Drugger here, seven pound,
He has had on him, in twopenny 'orths of tobacco.

Drugger Yes, sir. And he has damned himself three terms to pay me.

Face And what does he owe for *lotium*?

Drugger Thirty shillings, sir;
And for six syringes.

Pertinax Hydra of villainy!
Surly

Face Nay, sir, you must quarrel him out o' the house.
I will:

Kastril —Sir, if you get not out of doors, you lie;
And you are a pimp.

Pertinax Why, this is madness, sir,
Surly Not valour in you; I must laugh at this.

Kastril It is my humour: you are a pimp and a trig,
And an Amadis de Gaul, or a Don Quixote.

Drugger Or a knight o' the curious coxcomb, do you see?
Enter ANANIAS.

Ananias Peace to the household!

Kastril I'll keep peace for no man.

Ananias Casting of dollars is concluded lawful.

Kastril Is he the constable?

Subtle Peace, Ananias.

Face No, sir.

Kastril Then you are an otter, and a shad, a whit,
A very tim.

Pertinax You'll hear me, sir?
Surly

Kastril	I will not.
Ananias	What is the motive?
Subtle	Zeal in the young gentleman, Against his Spanish slops.
Ananias	They are profane, Lewd, superstitious, and idolatrous breeches.
Pertinax	New rascals!
Surly	
Kastril	Will you begone, sir?
	Avoid, Satan!
	Thou art not of the light: That ruff of pride About thy neck, betrays thee; and is the same With that which the unclean birds, in seventy-seven, Were seen to prank it with on divers coasts: Thou look'st like Antichrist, in that lewd hat.
Ananias	
Pertinax	I must give way.
Surly	
Kastril	Be gone, sir.
Pertinax	But I'll take
Surly	A course with you—
Ananias	Depart, proud Spanish fiend!
Pertinax	Captain and Doctor.
Surly	
Ananias	Child of perdition!
Kastril	Hence, sir!—
	<i>Exit SURLY.</i>
	Did I not quarrel bravely?
Face	Yes, indeed, sir.
Kastril	Nay, an I give my mind to't, I shall do't.
Face	O, you must follow, sir, and threaten him tame: He'll turn again else.
Kastril	I'll return him then.
	<i>Exit.</i>

SUBTLE takes ANANIAS aside.

Drugger, this rogue prevented us for thee:
We had determined that thou should'st have come
Face In a Spanish suit, and have carried her so; and he,
A brokerly slave! Goes, puts it on himself.
Hast brought the damask?
Drugger Yes, sir.
Face Thou must borrow
A Spanish suit. Hast thou no credit with the players?
Drugger Yes, sir; did you never see me play the Fool?
I know not, Nab: *Aside*.—Thou shalt, if I can help it.—
Face Hieronimo's old cloak, ruff, and hat will serve;
I'll tell thee more when thou bring'st 'em.

Exit DRUGGER.

Sir, I know
The Spaniard hates the Brethren, and hath spies
Upon their actions: and that this was one
Ananias I make no scruple.—But the holy Synod
Have been in prayer and meditation for it;
And 'tis revealed no less to them than me,
That casting of money is most lawful.
True.
But here I cannot do it: if the house
Subtle Should chance to be suspected, all would out,
And we be locked up in the Tower forever,
To make gold there for the state, never come out;
And then are you defeated.

I will tell
Ananias This to the Elders and the weaker Brethren,
That the whole company of the separation
May join in humble prayer again.

Subtle And fasting.

Ananias Yea, for some fitter place. The peace of mind
Rest with these walls!

Exit.

Subtle Thanks, courteous Ananias.
 Face What did he come for?
 About casting dollars,
 Subtle Presently out of hand. And so I told him,
 A Spanish minister came here to spy,
 Against the faithful —
 I conceive. Come, Subtle,
 Face Thou art so down upon the least disaster!
 How wouldst thou ha' done, if I had not help't thee out?
 Subtle I thank thee, Face, for the angry boy, i' faith.
 Who would have looked it should have been that rascal,
 Face Surly? He had dyed his beard and all. Well, sir.
 Here's damask come to make you a suit.
 Subtle Where's Druggier?
 Face He is gone to borrow me a Spanish habit;
 I'll be the count, now.
 Subtle But where's the widow?
 Face Within, with my lord's sister; Madam Dol
 Is entertaining her.
 Subtle By your favour, Face,
 Now she is honest, I will stand again.
 Face You will not offer it.
 Subtle Why?
 Face Stand to your word,
 Or—here comes Dol, she knows—
 Subtle You are tyrannous still.
Enter DOL, hastily.
 Strict for my right.—How now, Dol!
 Face Hast [thou] told her,
 The Spanish count will come?
 Dol Common Yes; but another is come,
 You little looked for!
 Face Who's that?
 Dol Common Your master;

The master of the house.

Subtle How, Dol!

Face She lies,
This is some trick. Come, leave your quibblins, Dorothy.

Dol Common Look out, and see.
FACE goes to the window.

Subtle Art thou in earnest?

Dol Common 'Slight,
Forty of the neighbours are about him, talking.

Face 'Tis he, by this good day.

Dol Common 'Twill prove ill day
For some on us.

Face We are undone, and taken.

Dol Common Lost, I'm afraid.

Subtle You said he would not come,
While there died one a week within the liberties.

Face No: 'twas within the walls.

Subtle Was't so! Cry you mercy.
I thought the liberties. What shall we do now, Face?
Be silent: not a word, if he call or knock.
I'll into mine old shape again and meet him,
Of Jeremy, the butler. In the meantime,
Do you two pack up all the goods and purchase,
That we can carry in the two trunks. I'll keep him
Off for today, if I cannot longer: and then

Face At night, I'll ship you both away to Ratcliff,
Where we will meet tomorrow, and there we'll share.
Let Mammon's brass and pewter keep the cellar;
We'll have another time for that. But, Dol,
'Prythee go heat a little water quickly;
Subtle must shave me: all my Captain's beard
Must off, to make me appear smooth Jeremy.
You'll do it?

Subtle Yes, I'll shave you, as well as I can.

Face And not cut my throat, but trim me?

Subtle You shall see, sir.

Exeunt.

ACT V

SCENE I

Before LOVEWIT's door.

Enter LOVEWIT, with several of the NEIGHBOURS.

Lovewit Has there been such resort, say you?

1 Neighbour Daily, sir.

2 Neighbour And nightly, too.

3 Neighbour Ay, some as brave as lords.

4 Neighbour Ladies and gentlewomen.

5 Neighbour Citizens' wives.

1 Neighbour And knights.

6 Neighbour In coaches.

2 Neighbour Yes, and oyster women.

1 Neighbour Beside other gallants.

3 Neighbour Sailors' wives.

4 Neighbour Tobacco men.

5 Neighbour Another Pimlico!

Lovewit What should my knave advance,
To draw this company? He hung out no banners
Of a strange calf with five legs to be seen,
Or a huge lobster with six claws?

6 Neighbour	No, sir.
3 Neighbour	We had gone in then, sir. He has no gift Of teaching in the nose that e'er I knew of. You saw no bills set up that promised cure Of agues, or the toothache?
Lovewit	
2 Neighbour	No such thing, sir!
Lovewit	Nor heard a drum struck for baboons or puppets?
5 Neighbour	Neither, sir. What device should he bring forth now? I love a teeming wit as I love my nourishment: 'Pray God he have not kept such open house, That he hath sold my hangings, and my bedding! I left him nothing else. If he have eat them, A plague o' the moth, say I! Sure he has got Some bawdy pictures to call all this ging! The friar and the nun; or the new motion Of the knight's courser covering the parson's mare; Or 't may be, he has the fleas that run at tilt Upon a table, or some dog to dance. When saw you him?
1 Neighbour	Who, sir, Jeremy?
2 Neighbour	Jeremy butler? We saw him not this month.
Lovewit	How!
4 Neighbour	Not these five weeks, sir.
6 Neighbour	These six weeks at the least.
Lovewit	You amaze me, neighbours!
5 Neighbour	Sure, if your worship know not where he is, He's slipt away.
6 Neighbour	Pray God, he be not made away.
Lovewit	Ha! It's no time to question, then. <i>Knocks at the door.</i>
6 Neighbour	About

	Some three weeks since, I heard a doleful cry, As I sat up a mending my wife's stockings.
Lovewit	'Tis strange that none will answer! Didst thou hear A cry, sayst thou?
6 Neighbour	Yes, sir, like unto a man That had been strangled an hour, and could not speak.
2 Neighbour	I heard it too, just this day three weeks, at two o'clock Next morning.
Lovewit	These be miracles, or you make them so! A man an hour strangled, and could not speak, And both you heard him cry?
3 Neighbour	Yes, downward, sir.
Lovewit	Thou art a wise fellow. Give me thy hand, I pray thee. What trade art thou on?
3 Neighbour	A smith, and't please your worship.
Lovewit	A smith! Then lend me thy help to get this door open.
3 Neighbour	That I will presently, sir, but fetch my tools— <i>Exit.</i>
1 Neighbour	Sir, best to knock again, afore you break it.
Lovewit	I will. <i>Knocks again.</i> <i>Enter FACE, in his butler's livery.</i>
Face	What mean you, sir?
1, 2, 4 Neighbour	O, here's Jeremy!
Face	Good sir, come from the door.
Lovewit	Why, what's the matter?
Face	Yet farther, you are too near yet.
Lovewit	In the name of wonder, What means the fellow!
Face	The house, sir, has been visited.
Lovewit	What, with the plague? Stand thou then farther.
Face	No, sir, I had it not.

Lovewit	Who had it then? I left None else but thee in the house.
Face	Yes, sir, my fellow, The cat that kept the buttery, had it on her A week before I spied it; but I got her Conveyed away in the night: and so I shut The house up for a month—
Lovewit	How!
Face	Purposing then, sir, To have burnt rose-vinegar, treacle, and tar, And have made it sweet, that you should ne'er have known it; Because I knew the news would but afflict you, sir. Breathe less, and farther off! Why this is stranger: The neighbours tell me all here that the doors Have still been open—
Face	How, sir!
Lovewit	Gallants, men and women, And of all sorts, tag-rag, been seen to flock here In threaves, these ten weeks, as to a second Hogsden, In days of Pimlico and Eye-bright.
Face	Sir, Their wisdoms will not say so.
Lovewit	Today they speak Of coaches and gallants; one in a French hood Went in, they tell me; and another was seen In a velvet gown at the window: divers more Pass in and out.
Face	They did pass through the doors then, Or walls, I assure their eyesights, and their spectacles; For here, sir, are the keys, and here have been, In this my pocket, now above twenty days: And for before, I kept the fort alone there. But that 'tis yet not deep in the afternoon, I should believe my neighbours had seen double

Through the black pot, and made these apparitions!
 For, on my faith to your worship, for these three weeks
 And upwards the door has not been opened.

Lovewit Strange!

1 Neighbour Good faith, I think I saw a coach.

2 Neighbour And I too,
 I'd have been sworn.

Lovewit Do you but think it now?
 And but one coach?

4 Neighbour We cannot tell, sir: Jeremy
 Is a very honest fellow.

Face Did you see me at all?

1 Neighbour No; that we are sure on.

2 Neighbour I'll be sworn o' that.

Lovewit Fine rogues to have your testimonies built on!
 Re-enter 3 NEIGHBOUR, with his tools.

3 Neighbour Is Jeremy come!

1 Neighbour O yes; you may leave your tools;
 We were deceived, he says.

2 Neighbour He has had the keys;
 And the door has been shut these three weeks.

3 Neighbour Like enough.

Lovewit Peace, and get hence, you changelings.
 Enter SURLY and MAMMON.
 Aside. Surly come!

Face And Mammon made acquainted! They'll tell all.
 How shall I beat them off? What shall I do?
 Nothing's more wretched than a guilty conscience.

Pertinax Surly No, sir, he was a great physician. This,
 It was no bawdyhouse, but a mere chance!
 You knew the lord and his sister.

Sir Epicure
 Mammon Nay, good Surly.—

Pertinax Surly The happy word, *Be Rich*—

Sir Epicure Mammon	Play not the tyrant.—
	“Should be today pronounced to all your friends.”
Pertinax Surly	And where be your andirons now? And your brass pots, That should have been golden flagons, and great wedges?
Sir Epicure Mammon	Let me but breathe. What, they have shut their doors, Methinks!
Pertinax Surly	Ay, now 'tis holiday with them.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Rogues, <i>He and SURLY knock.</i> Cozeners, imposters, bawds!
Face	What mean you, sir?
Sir Epicure Mammon	To enter if we can.
	Another man's house!
Face	Here is the owner, sir: turn you to him, And speak your business.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Are you, sir, the owner?
Lovewit	Yes, sir.
Sir Epicure Mammon	And are those knaves within your cheaters!
Lovewit	What knaves, what cheaters?
Sir Epicure Mammon	Subtle and his Lungs.
	The gentleman is distracted, sir! No lungs,
Face	Nor lights have been seen here these three weeks, sir, Within these doors, upon my word.
Pertinax Surly	Your word, Groom arrogant!
Face	Yes, sir, I am the housekeeper, And know the keys have not been out of my hands.
Pertinax Surly	This is a new Face.

Face You do mistake the house, sir:
 What sign was't at?
 You rascal! This is one
 Pertinax Surly Of the confederacy. Come, let's get officers,
 And force the door.
 Lovewit 'Pray you stay, gentlemen.
 Pertinax Surly No, sir, we'll come with warrant.
 Sir Epicure Ay, and then
 Mammon We shall have your doors open.
 Exeunt MAMMON and SURLY.
 Lovewit What means this?
 Face I cannot tell, sir.
 1 Neighbour These are two of the gallants
 That we do think we saw.
 Two of the fools!
 Your talk as idly as they. Good faith, sir,
 Face I think the moon has crazed 'em all.—
 Aside.
 O me,
 Enter KASTRIL.
 The angry boy come too! He'll make a noise,
 And ne'er away till he have betrayed us all.
 Knocking.
 What rogues, bawds, slaves, you'll open the door, anon!
 Kastril Punk, cockatrice, my sister! By this light
 I'll fetch the marshal to you. You are a whore
 To keep your castle—
 Face Who would you speak with, sir?
 Kastril The bawdy Doctor, and the cozening Captain,
 And puss my sister.
 Lovewit This is something, sure.
 Face Upon my trust, the doors were never open, sir.
 Kastril I have heard all their tricks told me twice over,
 By the fat knight and the lean gentleman.

Lovewit	Here comes another. <i>Enter ANANIAS and TRIBULATION.</i>
Face	Ananias too! And his pastor!
Tribulation	<i>Beating at the door.</i>
Wholesome	The doors are shut against us. Come forth, you seed of sulphur, sons of fire!
Ananias	Your stench it is broke forth; abomination Is in the house.
Kastril	Ay, my sister's there.
Ananias	The place, It is become a cage of unclean birds.
Kastril	Yes, I will fetch the scavenger, and the constable.
Tribulation	You shall do well.
Wholesome	
Ananias	We'll join to weed them out.
Kastril	You will not come then, punk devise, my sister!
Ananias	Call her not sister; she's a harlot verily.
Kastril	I'll raise the street.
Lovewit	Good gentlemen, a word.
Ananias	Satan avoid, and hinder not our zeal! <i>Exeunt ANANIAS, TRIBULATION, and KASTRIL.</i>
Lovewit	The world's turned Bedlam. These are all broke loose,
Face	Out of St. Katherine's, where they use to keep The better sort of mad-folks.
1 Neighbour	All these persons We saw go in and out here.
2 Neighbour	Yes, indeed, sir.
3 Neighbour	These were the parties. Peace, you drunkards! Sir,
Face	I wonder at it: please you to give me leave To touch the door, I'll try an the lock be changed.

Lovewit	It mazes me!
	<i>Goes to the door.</i> Good faith, sir, I believe
Face	There's no such thing: 'tis all <i>deceptio visus</i> .—
	<i>Aside.</i>
	Would I could get him away.
Dapper	<i>Within.</i> Master Captain! Master Doctor!
Lovewit	Who's that?
Face	<i>Aside.</i> Our clerk within, that I forgot!
	I know not, sir.
Dapper	<i>Within.</i> For God's sake, when will her Grace be at leisure?
	Ha!
Face	Illusions, some spirit o' the air—
	<i>Aside.</i> His gag is melted,
	And now he sets out the throat.
Dapper	<i>Within.</i> I am almost stifled—
Face	<i>Aside.</i> Would you were altogether.
	'Tis in the house.
Lovewit	Ha! List.
Face	Believe it, sir, in the air.
Lovewit	Peace, you.
Dapper	<i>Within.</i> Mine aunt's Grace does not use me well.
Subtle	<i>Within.</i> You fool,
	Peace, you'll mar all.
Face	<i>Speaks through the keyhole, while LOVEWIT advances to the door unobserved.</i>
	Or you will else, you rogue.
	O, is it so? Then you converse with spirits!—
Lovewit	Come, sir. No more of your tricks, good Jeremy.
	The truth, the shortest way.
Face	Dismiss this rabble, sir.—
	<i>Aside.</i> What shall I do? I am caught.
Lovewit	Good neighbours,
	I thank you all. You may depart.

Exeunt NEIGHBOURS.

	—Come, sir, You know that I am an indulgent master; And therefore conceal nothing. What's your medicine, To draw so many several sorts of wild fowl? Sir, you were wont to affect mirth and wit— But here's no place to talk on't in the street. Give me but leave to make the best of my fortune, And only pardon me the abuse of your house: It's all I beg. I'll help you to a widow, In recompence, that you shall give me thanks for, Will make you seven years younger, and a rich one. 'Tis but your putting on a Spanish cloak: I have her within. You need not fear the house; It was not visited.
Face	
Lovewit	But by me, who came Sooner than you expected.
Face	It is true, sir.
	'Pray you forgive me.
Lovewit	Well: let's see your widow.
	<i>Exeunt.</i>

SCENE II

A room in the same.

Enter SUBTLE, leading in DAPPER, with his eyes bound as before.

Subtle How! You have eaten your gag?

Dapper Yes faith, it crumbled
Away in my mouth.

Subtle You have spoiled all then.

Dapper No!
I hope my aunt of Fairy will forgive me.

Subtle Your aunt's a gracious lady; but in troth
You were to blame.

Dapper The fume did overcome me,
And I did do't to stay my stomach. 'Pray you
So satisfy her Grace.

Enter FACE, in his uniform.
Here comes the Captain.

Face How now! Is his mouth down?

Subtle Ay, he has spoken!

Face A pox, I heard him, and you too.—He's undone then.—
I have been fain to say, the house is haunted
With spirits, to keep churl back.

Subtle And hast thou done it?

Face Sure, for this night.

Subtle Why, then triumph and sing
Of Face so famous, the precious king
Of present wits.

Face Did you not hear the coil
About the door?

Subtle Yes, and I dwindled with it.

Face Show him his aunt, and let him be dispatched:
I'll send her to you.

Exit FACE.
Well, sir, your aunt her Grace
Will give you audience presently, on my suit,
And the Captain's word that you did not eat your gag
In any contempt of her Highness.

Unbinds his eyes.

Dapper Not I, in troth, sir.

Enter DOL, like the Queen of Fairy.

Subtle Here she is come. Down o' your knees and wriggle:

She has a stately presence.
DAPPER kneels, and shuffles towards her.
Good! Yet nearer,
And bid, God save you!

Dapper Madam!

Subtle And your aunt.

Dapper And my most gracious aunt, God save your Grace.

 Nephew, we thought to have been angry with you;

Dol But that sweet face of yours hath turned the tide,

Common And made it flow with joy, that ebb'd of love.

 Arise, and touch our velvet gown.

Subtle The skirts,
 And kiss 'em. So!

Dol Let me now stroke that head.

Common "Much, nephew, shalt thou win, much shalt thou spend,
 Much shalt thou give away, much shalt thou lend."

Subtle *Aside.* Ay, much! Indeed.— Why do you not thank her Grace?

Dapper I cannot speak for joy.

Subtle See, the kind wretch!
 Your Grace's kinsman right.

 Give me the bird.

Dol Here is your fly in a purse, about your neck, cousin;

Common Wear it, and feed it about this day sev'n-night,
 On your right wrist—

Subtle Open a vein with a pin,
 And let it suck but once a week; till then,
 You must not look on't.

Dol No: and kinsman,

Common Bear yourself worthy of the blood you come on.

Subtle Her Grace would have you eat no more Woolsack pies,
 Nor Dagger frumety.

Dol Nor break his fast

Common In Heaven and Hell.

Subtle She's with you everywhere!

Nor play with costermongers, at mum-chance, tray-trip,
 God make you rich; (when as your aunt has done it);
 But keep
 The gallantest company, and the best games —

Dapper Yes, sir.

Subtle Glee and primero; and what you get, be true to us.

Dapper By this hand, I will.
 You may bring's a thousand pound

Subtle Before tomorrow night, if but three thousand
 Be stirring, an you will.

Dapper I swear I will then.

Subtle Your fly will learn you all games.

Face *Within.* Have you done there?

Subtle Your Grace will command him no more duties?
 No:
 But come, and see me often. I may chance

Dol To leave him three or four hundred chests of treasure,
 Common And some twelve thousand acres of Fairyland,
 If he game well and comely with good gamesters.

Subtle There's a kind aunt! Kiss her departing part. —
 But you must sell your forty mark a year, now.

Dapper Ay, sir, I mean.

Subtle Or, give't away; pox on't!

Dapper I'll give't mine aunt. I'll go and fetch the writings.
Exit.

Subtle 'Tis well — away!
Re-enter FACE.

Face Where's Subtle?

Subtle Here: what news?
 Drugger is at the door, go take his suit,
 And bid him fetch a parson, presently;

Face Say, he shall marry the widow. Thou shalt spend
 A hundred pound by the service!
Exit SUBTLE.

	Now, queen Dol, Have you packed up all?
Dol Common	Yes.
Face	And how do you like The lady Pliant?
Dol Common	A good dull innocent.
	<i>Re-enter SUBTLE.</i>
Subtle	Here's your Hieronimo's cloak and hat.
Face	Give me them.
Subtle	And the ruff too?
Face	Yes; I'll come to you presently. <i>Exit.</i>
Subtle	Now he is gone about his project, Dol, I told you of, for the widow.
Dol Common	'Tis direct Against our articles.
Subtle	Well, we will fit him, wench. Hast thou gulled her of her jewels or her bracelets?
Dol Common	No; but I will do't.
Subtle	Soon at night, my Dolly, When we are shipped, and all our goods aboard, Eastward for Ratcliff, we will turn our course To Brainford, westward, if thou sayst the word, And take our leaves of this o'er-weening rascal, This peremptory Face.
Dol Common	Content, I'm weary of him.
Subtle	Thou'st cause, when the slave will run a wiving, Dol, Against the instrument that was drawn between us.
Dol Common	I'll pluck his bird as bare as I can.

Subtle Yes, tell her,
 She must by any means address some present
 To the cunning man, make him amends for wronging
 His art with her suspicion; send a ring,
 Or chain of pearl; she will be tortured else
 Extremely in her sleep, say, and have strange things
 Come to her. Wilt thou?

Dol
Common Yes.

Subtle My fine flitter-mouse,
 My bird o' the night! We'll tickle it at the Pigeons,
 When we have all, and may unlock the trunks,
 And say, this's mine, and thine; and thine, and mine.
 They kiss.
 Re-enter FACE.

Face What now! A billing?

Subtle Yes, a little exalted
 In the good passage of our stock-affairs.

Face Drugger has brought his parson; take him in, Subtle,
 And send Nab back again to wash his face.

Subtle I will: and shave himself?
 Exit.

Face If you can get him.

Dol
Common You are hot upon it, Face, whate'er it is!

Face A trick that Dol shall spend ten pound a month by.
 Re-enter SUBTLE.

 Is he gone?

Subtle The chaplain waits you in the hall, sir.

Face I'll go bestow him.
 Exit.

Dol
Common He'll now marry her, instantly.

Subtle He cannot yet, he is not ready. Dear Dol,

Cozen her of all thou canst. To deceive him
Is no deceit, but justice, that would break
Such an inextricable tie as ours was.

Dol
Common

Let me alone to fit him.

Re-enter FACE.

Face

Come, my venturers,
You have packed up all? Where be the trunks? Bring forth.

Subtle

Here.

Face

Let us see them. Where's the money?

Subtle

Here,
In this.

Face

Mammon's ten pound; eight score before:
The Brethren's money, this. Drugger's and Dapper's.
What paper's that?

Dol
Common

The jewel of the waiting maid's,
That stole it from her lady, to know certain—

Face

If she should have precedence of her mistress?

Dol
Common

Yes.

Face

What box is that?

Subtle

The fishwives' rings, I think,
And the alewives' single money. Is't not, Dol?

Dol
Common

Yes; and the whistle that the sailor's wife
Brought you to know an her husband were with Ward.

Face

We'll wet it tomorrow; and our silver-beakers
And tavern cups. Where be the French petticoats,
And girdles and hangers?

Subtle

Here, in the trunk,
And the bolts of lawn.

Face

Is Drugger's damask there,
And the tobacco?

Subtle

Yes.

Face

Give me the keys.

Dol Common	Why you the keys?
Subtle	No matter, Dol; because We shall not open them before he comes.
Face	'Tis true, you shall not open them, indeed; Nor have them forth, do you see? Not forth, Dol.
Dol Common	No!
	No, my smock rampant. The right is, my master Knows all, has pardoned me, and he will keep them; Doctor, 'tis true—you look—for all your figures: I sent for him, indeed. Wherefore, good partners, Both he and she be satisfied; for here Determines the indenture tripartite 'Twixt Subtle, Dol, and Face. All I can do Is to help you over the wall, o' the backside, Or lend you a sheet to save your velvet gown, Dol. Here will be officers presently, bethink you Of some course suddenly to 'scape the dock: For thither you will come else.
Face	<i>Loud knocking.</i> Hark you, thunder.
Subtle	You are a precious fiend!
Officer	<i>Without.</i> Open the door.
Face	Dol, I am sorry for thee i' faith; but hear'st thou? It shall go hard but I will place thee somewhere: Thou shalt have my letter to mistress Amo—
Dol Common	Hang you!
Face	Or madam Caesarean.
Dol Common	Pox upon you, rogue, Would I had but time to beat thee!
Face	Subtle, Let's know where you set up next; I will send you

A customer now and then, for old acquaintance:
What new course have you?
Rogue, I'll hang myself;
Subtle That I may walk a greater devil than thou,
And haunt thee in the flock-bed and the buttery.
Exeunt.

SCENE III

An outer room in the same.

Enter LOVEWIT in the Spanish dress, with the PARSON. Loud knocking at the door.

Lovewit What do you mean, my masters?

Sir Epicure *Without.* Open your door,

Mammon Cheaters, bawds, conjurers.

Officer *Without.* Or we will break it open.

Lovewit What warrant have you?

Officer *Without.* Warrant enough, sir, doubt not,
If you'll not open it.

Lovewit Is there an officer, there?

Officer *Without.* Yes, two or three for failing.

Lovewit Have but patience,
And I will open it straight.

Enter FACE, as butler.

Face Sir, have you done?
Is it a marriage? Perfect?

Lovewit Yes, my brain.

Face Off with your ruff and cloak then; be yourself, sir.

Pertinax Surly *Without.* Down with the door.

Kastril	<i>Without.</i> 'Slight, ding it open.
Lovewit	<i>Opening the door.</i> Hold, Hold, gentlemen, what means this violence? <i>MAMMON, SURLY, KASTRIL, ANANIAS, TRIBULATION, and OFFICERS, rush in.</i>
Sir Epicure Mammon	Where is this collier?
Pertinax Surly	And my Captain Face?
Sir Epicure Mammon	These day owls.
Pertinax Surly	That are birding in men's purses.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Madam Suppository.
Kastril	Doxy, my sister.
Ananias	Locusts Of the foul pit.
Tribulation Wholesome	Profane as Bel and the dragon.
Ananias	Worse than the grasshoppers, or the lice of Egypt.
Lovewit	Good gentlemen, hear me. Are you officers, And cannot stay this violence?
1 Officer	Keep the peace.
Lovewit	Gentlemen, what is the matter? Whom do you seek?
Sir Epicure Mammon	The chemical cozener.
Pertinax Surly	And the Captain pander.
Kastril	The nun my sister.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Madam Rabbi.
Ananias	Scorpions, And caterpillars.
Lovewit	Fewer at once, I pray you.
2 Officer	One after another, gentlemen, I charge you,

	By virtue of my staff.
Ananias	They are the vessels Of pride, lust, and the cart.
Lovewit	Good zeal, lie still A little while.
Tribulation Wholesome	Peace, deacon Ananias.
	The house is mine here, and the doors are open; If there be any such persons as you seek for, Use your authority, search on o' God's name. I am but newly come to town, and finding This tumult 'bout my door, to tell you true, It somewhat mazed me; till my man, here, fearing My more displeasure, told me he had done Somewhat an insolent part, let out my house (Belike, presuming on my known aversion From any air o' the town while there was sickness,) To a Doctor and a Captain: who, what they are Or where they be, he knows not.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Are they gone?
Lovewit	You may go in and search, sir. <i>MAMMON, ANANIAS, and TRIBULATION go in.</i> Here, I find The empty walls worse than I left them, smoked, A few cracked pots, and glasses, and a furnace: The ceiling filled with poesies of the candle, And madam with a dildo writ o' the walls: Only one gentlewoman, I met here, That is within, that said she was a widow —
Kastril	Ay, that's my sister; I'll go thump her. Where is she? <i>Goes in.</i>
Lovewit	And should have married a Spanish Count, but he, When he came to't, neglected her so grossly, That I, a widower, am gone through with her.

Pertinax Surly	How! Have I lost her then? Were you the Don, sir? Good faith, now, she does blame you extremely, and says You swore, and told her you had taken the pains To dye your beard, and umber o'er your face,
Lovewit	Borrowed a suit, and ruff, all for her love; And then did nothing. What an oversight, And want of putting forward, sir, was this! Well fare an old harquebuzier, yet, Could prime his powder, and give fire, and hit, All in a twinkling! <i>Re-enter MAMMON.</i>
Sir Epicure Mammon	The whole nest are fled!
Lovewit	What sort of birds were they? A kind of choughs, Or thievish daws, sir, that have picked my purse
Sir Epicure Mammon	Of eight score and ten pounds within these five weeks, Beside my first materials; and my goods, That lie in the cellar, which I am glad they have left, I may have home yet.
Lovewit	Think you so, sir?
Sir Epicure Mammon	Ay.
Lovewit	By order of law, sir, but not otherwise.
Sir Epicure Mammon	Not mine own stuff! Sir, I can take no knowledge That they are yours, but by public means.
Lovewit	If you can bring certificate that you were gulled of them, Or any formal writ out of a court, That you did cozen yourself, I will not hold them.
Sir Epicure Mammon	I'll rather lose them.
Lovewit	That you shall not, sir,

	By me, in troth: upon these terms, they are yours. What! Should they have been, sir, turned into gold, all?
Sir Epicure Mammon	No, I cannot tell—It may be they should.—What then?
Lovewit	What a great loss in hope have you sustained!
Sir Epicure Mammon	Not I, the Commonwealth has.
	Ay, he would have built The city new; and made a ditch about it
Face	Of silver, should have run with cream from Hogsden; That every Sunday, in Moorfields, the youngers, And tits and tomboys should have fed on, gratis.
Sir Epicure Mammon	I will go mount a turnip-cart, and preach The end of the world, within these two months. Surly, What! In a dream?
	Must I needs cheat myself, With that same foolish vice of honesty!
Pertinax Surly	Come, let us go and hearken out the rogues: That Face I'll mark for mine, if e'er I meet him.
	If I can hear of him, sir, I'll bring you word,
Face	Unto your lodging; for in troth, they were strangers To me, I thought them honest as myself, sir.
	<i>Exeunt MAMMON and SURLY.</i>
	<i>Re-enter ANANIAS and TRIBULATION.</i>
Tribulation Wholesome	'Tis well, the saints shall not lose all yet. Go, And get some carts—
Lovewit	For what, my zealous friends?
Ananias	To bear away the portion of the righteous Out of this den of thieves.
Lovewit	What is that portion?
Ananias	The goods sometimes the orphan's, that the Brethren Bought with their silver pence.
Lovewit	What, those in the cellar, The knight Sir Mammon claims?

Ananias	I do defy The wicked Mammon, so do all the Brethren, Thou profane man! I ask thee with what conscience Thou canst advance that idol against us, That have the seal? Were not the shillings numbered, That made the pounds; were not the pounds told out, Upon the second day of the fourth week, In the eighth month, upon the table dormant, The year of the last patience of the saints, Six hundred and ten?
Lovewit	Mine earnest vehement botcher, And deacon also, I cannot dispute with you: But if you get you not away the sooner, I shall confute you with a cudgel.
Ananias	Sir!
Tribulation Wholesome	Be patient, Ananias.
Ananias	I am strong, And will stand up, well girt, against an host That threaten Gad in exile.
Lovewit	I shall send you To Amsterdam, to your cellar.
Ananias	I will pray there, Against thy house: may dogs defile thy walls, And wasps and hornets breed beneath thy roof, This seat of falsehood, and this cave of cozenage!
	<i>Exeunt ANANIAS and TRIBULATION.</i>
	<i>Enter DRUGGER.</i>
Lovewit	Another too?
Drugger	Not I, sir, I am no Brother.
Lovewit	<i>Beats him.</i> Away, you Harry Nicholas! Do you talk?
	<i>Exit DRUGGER.</i>
Face	No, this was Abel Drugger. Good sir, go, <i>To the PARSON.</i>

And satisfy him; tell him all is done:
He stayed too long a washing of his face.
The Doctor, he shall hear of him at Westchester;
And of the Captain, tell him, at Yarmouth, or
Some good port town else, lying for a wind.

Exit PARSON.

If you can get off the angry child, now, sir—

Enter KASTRIL, dragging in his sister.

Come on, you ewe, you have matched most sweetly,
have you not?

Kastril Did not I say, I would never have you tupp'd
But by a dubbed boy, to make you a lady tom?
'Slight, you are a mammet! O, I could touse you, now.
Death, mun' you marry, with a pox!

Lovewit You lie, boy;
As sound as you; and I'm aforehand with you.

Kastril Anon!

Lovewit Come, will you quarrel? I will feize you, sirrah;
Why do you not buckle to your tools?

Kastril Od's light,
This is a fine old boy as e'er I saw!

Lovewit What, do you change your copy now? Proceed;
Here stands my dove: stoop at her, if you dare.
'Slight, I must love him! I cannot choose, i' faith,
Kastril An I should be hanged for't! Sister, I protest,
I honour thee for this match.

Lovewit O, do you so, sir?

Kastril Yes, an thou canst take tobacco and drink, old boy,
I'll give her five hundred pound more to her marriage,
Than her own state.

Lovewit Fill a pipe full, Jeremy.

Face Yes; but go in and take it, sir.

Lovewit We will—
I will be ruled by thee in anything, Jeremy.

Kastril 'Slight, thou art not hidebound, thou art a jovy boy!
Come, let us in, I pray thee, and take our whiffs.

Lovewit Whiff in with your sister, brother boy.

Exeunt KASTRIL and DAME PLIANT.

That master
That had received such happiness by a servant,
In such a widow, and with so much wealth,
Were very ungrateful, if he would not be
A little indulgent to that servant's wit,
And help his fortune, though with some small strain
Of his own candour.

Advancing.

—“Therefore, gentlemen,
And kind spectators, if I have outstript
An old man's gravity, or strict canon, think
What a young wife and a good brain may do;
Stretch age's truth sometimes, and crack it too.
Speak for thyself, knave.”

Face “So I will, sir.”

Advancing to the front of the stage.

“Gentlemen,
My part a little fell in this last scene,
Yet 'twas decorum. And though I am clean
Got off from Subtle, Surly, Mammon, Dol,
Hot Ananias, Dapper, Drugger, all
With whom I traded: yet I put myself
On you, that are my country: and this pelf
Which I have got, if you do quit me, rests
To feast you often, and invite new guests.”



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Table of Contents

1. [Titlepage](#)
2. [Imprint](#)
3. [Dramatis Personae](#)
4. [Dedication](#)
5. [To the Reader](#)
6. [The Alchemist](#)
 1. [Argument](#)
 2. [Prologue](#)
 3. [Act I](#)
 1. [Scene I](#)
 4. [Act II](#)
 1. [Scene I](#)
 5. [Act III](#)
 1. [Scene I](#)
 2. [Scene II](#)
 6. [Act IV](#)
 1. [Scene I](#)
 2. [Scene II](#)
 3. [Scene III](#)
 4. [Scene IV](#)
 7. [Act V](#)
 1. [Scene I](#)
 2. [Scene II](#)
 3. [Scene III](#)
7. [Colophon](#)
8. [Uncopyright](#)